Supplementary Information

Cloudra: Geometric Reasoning and Scientific Validation for Autonomous Reaction Mechanism Exploration

Chengyi Yang [1,*], Qianxin Zhou [2], and Yang Li [1]

[1]College of Chemistry and Pharmaceutical Engineering, Changsha University of Science and Technology, Changsha 410114, China
[2]State Key Laboratory of Photocatalysis on Energy and Environment, College of Chemistry, Fuzhou University, Fuzhou 350002, China

[*]Corresponding author: Chengyi Yang. E-mail: 202509240114@csust.edu.cn.

Draft — 31 October 2026

This supplement provides the experimental protocol, layered evaluation, complete task and score tables, expanded diagnostic analyses, literature source register, and machine-readable materials accompanying the manuscript. Standard denotes the same-model backbone comparison; Record and Brief are workflow ablations. Section, table, figure, equation, and page numbers carry the prefix S to distinguish them from the main text.

Contents

S1 Benchmark design and experimental protocol **S2**
S1.1 Task specification and study units . . . S2
S1.2 Workflow configurations and primary comparison . . . S2
S1.3 P2 model configuration and campaign versions . . . S3
S1.4 Allowed calculations and reference definitions . . . S4
S1.5 Physical evidence associated with a mechanism . . . S4
S1.6 Offline organization and publication records . . . S4
S1.7 Paired statistical analysis and time measurements . . . S4

S2 Layered scoring and scientific completion **S5**
S2.1 Composite and reporting layers . . . S5
S2.2 Graph structure and chemical correspondence . . . S5
S2.3 Graded physical self-consistency . . . S5
S2.4 Electronic barriers and numerical accuracy . . . S5
S2.5 Qualitative selectivity and property targets . . . S6
S2.6 Impossible tasks and final scientific claims . . . S6
S2.7 Original delivery, organized evaluation, and score reproduction . . . S6

S3 CloudraBench task catalogue **S6**

S4 Detailed benchmark results and reaction-path analysis **S10**
S4.1 Complete workflow and tier comparisons . . . S10
S4.2 Graph delivery and evaluation of the run results . . . S11
S4.3 Elapsed research time and accumulated calculation effort . . . S11
S4.4 Conformer references and reaction-step assignments . . . S12
S4.5 Impossible-tier results and the requested negative conclusions . . . S13
S4.6 Easy-tier energy references and delivery trajectories . . . S14
S4.7 Sensitivity to target-object assignment in Impossible tasks . . . S15
S4.8 Discussion of the supplementary comparisons . . . S16
S4.9 Complete per-task and per-configuration scores . . . S16
S4.10 Expanded task-score matrices . . . S20

S5 Behavioral diagnostics and archived research trajectories **S21**
S5.1 Study materials and local inference settings . . . S21
S5.2 Chemical identity under equivalent representations and answer reversal . . . S22
S5.3 XYZ coordinates and explicitly measured distances . . . S23
S5.4 Target-specific geometric feedback in an E1 operation chain . . . S23

S5.5 Single-token transfer of a reported numerical fact . . . S23
S5.6 Evidence associations under fixed local calculation facts . . . S24
S5.7 From a detected gap to the next research action . . . S24
S5.8 Discussion of the diagnostic scope . . . S25

S6 Literature sample and source-linked capability register S25
S6.1 Selection and coding procedure . . . S25
S6.2 Source register and counting variants . . . S25

S7 Data, software, and reproduction materials S27
S7.1 Public data availability . . . S27
S7.2 Machine-readable task and score records . . . S28
S7.3 Software responsibilities and calculation records . . . S28
S7.4 Reproduction entry points . . . S28
S7.5 Data-package inventory . . . S28

S1 Benchmark design and experimental protocol

S1.1 Task specification and study units

CloudraBench tests whether agents can construct the requested species and reaction pathways, run the calculations, and draw conclusions supported by the results. It comprises 50 tasks: 20 Easy, 10 Normal, 10 Hard, and 10 Impossible. Easy tasks cover elementary transformations, conformational changes, and basic execution; Normal tasks require identifying intermediates and connecting successive elementary steps; Hard tasks compare competing pathways and stereochemical products; Impossible tasks require recognizing what the allowed electronic-structure methods can support. Each task specifies reactant and target identities, reaction conditions, total charge, spin multiplicity, requested results, and permitted methods. All configurations receive the same specifications for that task. The complete catalogue accompanies the per-task results.

The repeated-task study, P1b, measures repeated runs on four tasks; the full-benchmark study, P2, compares all 50 tasks (Table S1). P1b contains three independent runs for each task and configuration. E1 concerns elimination preorganization; NB1 concerns multistep decarboxylation; HA1 concerns stereochemical ring opening; and IA1 concerns an electronic-structure method limitation. P2 retains one run per task and configuration, so comparisons pair the four configurations on the same task. The 48 repeated-task runs and the 200 full-benchmark runs are analyzed separately.

Table S1. Experimental units in the two studies.

Design	Repeated-task study (P1b)	Full-benchmark study (P2)
Task set	E1, NB1, HA1, IA1	All 50 CloudraBench tasks
Backbone	DeepSeek-v4.1-flash (1017)	DeepSeek-v4.1-flash (1017); official DeepSeek chat-completions API
Configurations	Guided, Standard, Record, Brief-errors	Guided, Standard, Record, Brief-errors
Repetitions	Three per task and configuration	One retained run per task and configuration
Task-level runs	$4 \times 4 \times 3 = 48$	$50 \times 4 = 200$
Elapsed-time unit	Four-task batch at concurrency two; three batches per configuration	Computational effort on the common 15-task subset

S1.2 Workflow configurations and primary comparison

The primary comparison is Guided against Standard with the same model backbone. Record and Brief-errors test the effects of removing required physical validation and shortening diagnostics, respectively (Table S2). Standard provides computational tools and neutral feedback while leaving physical checks to the agent; explicit delivery-DAG tools are hidden. Guided retains the graph, required scientific checks, and detailed diagnostics. Record retains the tools and records while making physical validation optional. Brief-errors retains guidance and physical validation with shorter diagnostics. Every configuration has the same task and method restrictions.

Both studies used DeepSeek-v4.1-flash (1017). All eight saved coordinator and follower configurations and their model-call records use the API alias `deepseek-v4-flash`.[1] Each run retains its model name, campaign identifier, budget, stopping reason, and calculation files. Cloudra revision 70daa5a identifies the implementation described in the main-text methods.[2] Execution, scoring, and offline organization have separate version records; the versions used in each step are taken from its archive.

Table S2. Operational definition of the four workflow configurations. Brief-errors is abbreviated as Brief in figures and tables; Standard is also labelled Backbone.

Configuration	Delivery-graph interface	Required physical validation	Diagnostic presentation
Guided	Explicit	Retained	Detailed
Standard	Explicit DAG tools hidden	Removed	Neutral computation feedback
Record	Available tools and records retained	Removed	Recording retained
Brief-errors	Retained	Retained	Shortened

S1.3 P2 model configuration and campaign versions

P1b contains four tasks, four workflow configurations, and three runs per combination, giving 48 task runs. P2 contains 50 tasks under the four configurations, giving 200 retained task runs from the P2b and P2c campaigns. Three completed P2b runs were retained (Guided/D3, Record/D1, and Standard/D3); P2c supplied the remaining 197 runs.

The backbone was DeepSeek-v4.1-flash (1017). All eight saved P2 configurations, one per campaign and workflow combination, specify `deepseek-v4-flash` for both the coordinator and follower. The request-start and completion events in all eight runtime archives record that same identifier. Cloudra used the official DeepSeek endpoint with streaming OpenAI-compatible chat completions, the route selected by `native_search=auto` in the campaign implementation. Table S3 lists the request settings and execution versions, including both the deployment name and the API alias stored in the records.

Table S3. Frozen P2 configuration and campaign metadata. Request settings describe the harness configuration; telemetry counts are provided in the accompanying `p2_model_metadata.json`.

Item	Recorded value
Deployed model	DeepSeek-v4.1-flash (1017)
Provider and API alias	DeepSeek; `deepseek-v4-flash` in all eight snapshots and their request/completion telemetry
Endpoint and transport	`https://api.deepseek.com`; streaming chat completions
Role slots	Coordinator and follower use the same provider, model identifier, and request settings
Reasoning setting	Requested `reasoning_effort=minimal`
Temperature	1.0 in the archived run-start settings
Context window	400,000 tokens in the frozen harness configuration
Spawned-agent budget	`max_tokens=32768` in the archived `agent.spawned` settings; this budget applies to each agent request. Total run token consumption is a separate quantity.
Tool invocation	JavaScript protocol
Retained task runs	Three from P2b and 197 from P2c
Task concurrency	Two per configuration, eight in total
Campaign starts	P2b: 25 October 2026, 18:01:17 UTC+8; P2c: 25 October 2026, 22:18:45 UTC+8
Campaign base	`53309d0e`
Configuration commits	Guided: `6e89d20c`; Record: `746c33f0`; Standard: `c7fc94a1`; Brief-errors: `3b9831bb`. Both campaigns use these commits.

The configuration commits identify the code used to run the experiments. The main-text implementation, later evaluator fixes, and publication-table reproduction have separate version records. The companion metadata file gives the archive path of each configuration and runtime record. Its request-start and completion counts include auxiliary LLM calls and cancelled P2b attempts; the benchmark includes only the 200 retained task runs.

Fixed geometric heuristics. Atom maps are ranked with fixed costs: 2 for each formed or broken bond, 1 for each bond-order change, 4 for a hydrogen-count mismatch, 8 for charge or radical-electron mismatches, and 2 for a stereochemical mismatch. Maps within $J_{\min} + 2$ are retained when reporting ambiguity. The branch-crowding descriptor uses decay $\rho = 0.5$, traversal through depth five, and a congestion flag when the four-branch total $B_{\text{axis}} \geq 9.0$. These heuristics rank maps and flag structures for inspection. Physical validation uses the quantum-chemical results. The imaginary-mode participation ratio is compared with 0.5 as an advisory diagnostic; validation requires the first-order saddle and IRC/endpoint calculations.

Conformational sampling. Default preorganization places molecular fragments using their topology, relaxes them with guided MMFF94 optimization, and selects candidates by energy and RMSD. For multicomponent systems, it samples 32 relative orientations and retains up to eight guided placements. A separate conformer-search tool uses RDKit by default and offers CREST[3] for additional conformer or noncovalent-complex sampling. The default CREST route uses GFN2-xTB with the quick setting. The resulting geometries are candidates for subsequent calculations and must pass the task's stationary-point and pathway checks.

S1.4 Allowed calculations and reference definitions

Easy, Normal, and Hard tasks permit xTB, PM7, and B3LYP-D3(BJ)/def2-SVP.[4–11] Impossible tasks are restricted to xTB and PM7. Computational quantities and termination status are read from native ORCA, Gaussian, and MOPAC outputs.[12–15] Each result retains its program, calculation level, species, and task conditions.

The reference answer (Gold) specifies the mechanistic species and elementary steps, stereochemical identities, applicable numerical targets, and explicit negative targets. Numerical activation barriers use electronic energies at a consistent level of theory:

$$\Delta E_e^{\ddagger} = E_{\mathrm{TS},e} - E_{\mathrm{ref},e}. \tag{S1}$$

These benchmark barriers use electronic energies alone. The energy reference is the verified stable minimum of the corresponding species. Declared conformational connections within the same species can share that stable reference; a conformational conversion itself uses its own starting conformer. Distinct stereochemical substrates and independent channel contact complexes retain separate references. The IRC endpoint and the energy reference are recorded separately, since they can be different conformers of the same species.

References follow the individual task definitions. NB1_E2 and NQ5_E2 are exempt from numerical references under the specified proton-transfer policy. IB9 combines a numerical first-step reference of 5.65 kcal mol^{-1} with a negative second-step target. Section S2 specifies the qualitative selectivity targets and numerical tolerances. Each reference record separately states whether the task and Gold graph are available and whether the complete calculation chain has been physically validated.

S1.5 Physical evidence associated with a mechanism

A mechanism graph represents species occurrences as nodes and elementary steps as edges. A species minimum requires a converged optimization and zero imaginary frequencies. An accessible transition-state step requires a first-order saddle with exactly one imaginary frequency associated with the intended reaction, plus IRC results connecting that saddle to the declared endpoint species.[16, 17] Normal termination, geometry convergence, frequencies, and pathway connectivity are checked separately.

Both IRC directions must start at the same transition state. The actual outer frame from each direction is then optimized to a minimum with zero imaginary frequencies and the declared chemical identity and stereochemistry. This outer-frame–optimization–frequency chain can establish the connection from a short IRC. The frames and links between calculations are archived. Native calculation results establish the endpoint connection; geometric interval measurements aid interpretation. For separated products, the required constituent minima are verified; an intact molecular complex is evaluated as a whole-system species.

These requirements apply to the species and steps requested by the task. A negative conclusion marks the target inaccessible and records the reason. A species-only negative question is evaluated directly on that species claim.

S1.6 Offline organization and publication records

Formal evaluation represents the research completed by all four configurations in the same mechanism-graph format. Human organizers read each run's conversations, tool records, reports, geometries, and native calculation outputs, then encode the agent's stated species, steps, mechanistic intent, and conclusions. They recover graph entries, repair file references, and convert quantities already present in the run; each recovered field records its source. The evaluator searches that run's sandbox for native calculation results and applies the same physical criteria and scoring rules to every configuration. Organization is confined to that run's existing calculations and stated conclusions; Gold supplies the evaluation reference. The procedure and field sources allow the graph to be reconstructed from the original run materials.

The full-benchmark table contains 200 runs, all 600 Graph, Self-consistency, and Accuracy values, and their evaluation sources. The weighted components reproduce the final totals to four decimal places; Section S7 specifies the references and evaluator revision. The tables also record whether the run wrote a root mechanism graph and whether it was organized offline. Readers can therefore inspect graph delivery separately from the score for the run's research results.

The repeated-task study retains its historical results for all four configurations. The later offline organization updates Standard separately; the other configurations in the 48-run study retain their historical scores. Analyses of this archive identify which version supplies each result.

S1.7 Paired statistical analysis and time measurements

For a task i and configuration a, let S_{ia} denote its composite score. Configuration means give each task equal weight within the reported set. The primary paired difference is

$$\overline{\Delta}_{\mathrm{G-S}} = \frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n}\left(S_{i,\mathrm{Guided}} - S_{i,\mathrm{Standard}}\right). \tag{S2}$$

The same calculation is used within each tier and for the combined Normal/Hard subset. Weighted component contributions are the mean paired component differences multiplied by 0.1, 0.3, and 0.6, respectively. They add to the composite difference up to the reporting precision of the final scores.

The 95% percentile intervals use 100,000 task-cluster bootstrap samples with seed 20261031. Each draw selects a task with its four configuration records together, preserving the paired comparison.

Elapsed time in the repeated-task study runs from the recorded start to finish of each four-task batch at concurrency two: three batches per configuration, or 12 batches in total. It is measured in batch wall-clock hours. Full-benchmark effort is measured on the 15 tasks with records for all four configurations, comprising 60 task-level runs. Calculation counts and cumulative quantum-chemical job-hours are reported; job-hours sum the individual calculation durations within each run. For Standard/M1, native-log CPU time is divided by four to estimate job duration. The tables keep job-hours separate from core-hours and from the elapsed time of an entire P2 research run.

S2 Layered scoring and scientific completion

S2.1 Composite and reporting layers

For a formally organized run, the reported composite combines graph structure G, physical self-consistency C, and accuracy A:

$$S = 0.1G + 0.3C + 0.6A. \tag{S3}$$

The three components are reported separately, alongside execution status, original graph delivery, and completion of the requested steps. Complete scientific validation additionally requires every requested species and step to meet its physical criteria.

S2.2 Graph structure and chemical correspondence

The graph component measures how well the delivered mechanism covers the reference species and steps. For comparison, transition-state nodes are folded into their elementary-step edges. Species are matched by chemical identity; steps are compared by their endpoints and atom-mapped bond changes. RDKit represents the species and NetworkX represents and matches the graphs.[18, 19] Missing reference species or steps, incorrect chemical identities, and mismatched accessibility declarations add edit costs. The graph component permits additional nodes and edges.

Graph comparison ignores stereochemistry for Easy and Normal tasks and retains it for Hard tasks. A species' linked native calculation results determine which evidence is assessed for it. Graph coverage receives its own score independently of the binary self-consistency result.

S2.3 Graded physical self-consistency

Self-consistency is scored on the species and steps in the organized graph, independently of numerical agreement with Gold. Table S4 lists the credit for each calculation stage of a transition-state step; a complete verified chain receives 1.0. The evaluator searches the same run's sandbox for the native files and links between calculations, recovering file associations where needed. It assigns credit from these results using the common physical criteria.

Table S4. Graded self-consistency contribution for an accessible transition-state step. The endpoint contribution is 0.25 for one verified side and 0.50 for both sides.

Evidence stage	Contribution
Verified first-order saddle: exactly one imaginary frequency	0.35
IRC starting geometry consistent with the selected saddle	0.15
Native outer-frame–optimization–frequency lineage to both declared endpoint minima	0.50

For graphs containing reaction edges, C is the mean of the delivered edge scores. An edge represented by its endpoints alone requires coverage of both endpoint species. For a species-only graph, C is the mean species-coverage score. Explicit inaccessible targets are exempt from requirements for stationary points or paths judged physically nonexistent under the task's permitted methods and receive the corresponding self-consistency credit.

The binary self-consistency check requires all requested species and steps to pass, including minimum characterization and the full transition-state/IRC chain. Counts of $C = 1$ in the main text and score tables refer to full graded component scores. The binary check separately establishes whether the complete mechanism is validated. Fractional scores indicate which calculation stages have been supported.

S2.4 Electronic barriers and numerical accuracy

For a step with a numerical reference, the evaluator checks the declared barrier against the transition-state and starting-species energies in the native outputs. If the barrier field is empty, it can calculate the difference from those energies when both are reported and supported by their native records. The conversion factor from hartree to kcal mol^{-1} is 627.509474.

For a supported numerical value $\widehat{\Delta E}_e^{\ddagger}$ and reference $\Delta E_{e,\mathrm{Gold}}^{\ddagger}$, the underlying Gaussian score is

$$q_e = \exp\left[-\frac{\left(\widehat{\Delta E}_e^{\ddagger} - \Delta E_{e,\mathrm{Gold}}^{\ddagger}\right)^2}{2\sigma_e^2}\right]. \tag{S4}$$

The released task rubrics use base widths of 3.0 kcal mol^{-1} for Easy and Impossible tasks and 2.0 kcal mol^{-1} for Normal and Hard tasks. For a reference barrier at or below 10.0 kcal mol^{-1}, the reference-comparison width is the larger of the base width and 5.0 kcal mol^{-1}. This small-barrier width applies to comparison with Gold; the declaration-to-log consistency check retains the task's base width.

All reference edges remain in the accuracy denominator with their recorded weights. A numerical reference edge requires a matching delivered step, a declared barrier, and a log-derived value to receive credit. Missing any of these gives zero for that edge; other supported steps keep their credit. The combined penalty for numerical deviations on supported edges is capped at 0.3. Penalties for missing steps, missing evidence, and incorrect negative conclusions apply in full. For total reference-edge weight W, supported numerically graded edges D, and missing or incorrectly delivered targets U,

$$A = 1 - \min\left(\frac{\sum_{e\in D} w_e(1-q_e)}{W},\, 0.3\right) - \frac{\sum_{e\in U} w_e}{W}. \tag{S5}$$

Correct negative conclusions and accessible edges exempt from numerical references receive their prescribed full credit through W. For the latter, credit concerns the specified nonnumerical result.

The evaluator checks the allowed combinations of transition-state and reference energies in the delivered results. If one combination agrees with Gold and the reported barrier uses a different supported conformer or energy reference, the answer-definition rule replaces q_e with 0.9. An unsupported barrier declaration with zero reference-consistent alternatives triggers the integrity rule: the self-consistency and accuracy contributions become zero, leaving $0.1G$. An omitted step loses its own contribution.

S2.5 Qualitative selectivity and property targets

For HA1, HA6, HB1, and HF1, Accuracy scores the qualitative choice of favored channel. The delivered mechanism must identify one favored edge matching the reference channel or its product. Product identity is used when the agent's channel label differs from the reference label. Numerical barrier spreads are retained as calculations; the scored target is the qualitative channel preference. HL1 scores its independently referenced channel barriers.

For species-property tasks, Accuracy compares the declared properties with their references. Numerical comparison widths are 0.02 Å for bond lengths, 50 cm^{-1} for frequencies, and 2.0 kcal mol^{-1} for energy differences. State-ordering text is compared after case and whitespace normalization. When several properties are requested, their scores are averaged.

S2.6 Impossible tasks and final scientific claims

Impossible tasks are scored on the agent's final conclusion about the requested target. Correctly identifying that target as inaccessible or beyond the allowed method's capability earns negative-target credit, including after exploratory calculations. Credit is lost for an incorrect claim that the target is accessible, a barrier or property presented as trustworthy for that negative target, or omission of the required negative conclusion. Endpoint species associated with a negative step receive the same treatment. A species-only negative target is evaluated directly on the species claim.

A result must answer the question about the requested electronic state, species, or pathway. The per-task tables and case analyses identify that target alongside its score.

S2.7 Original delivery, organized evaluation, and score reproduction

Original delivery completeness records whether the run generated its mechanism graph during execution. Evaluation uses the graph organized by the common offline procedure in Section S1. The publication table records each run's final component scores and field sources. All configurations use the same final references and scoring rules.

The reproduction procedure reads the evaluation records to rebuild the per-run table, summaries, and figure data. It checks for 200 unique task/configuration records, 600 nonmissing component values, and agreement between the weighted components and the 200 final totals. The maximum absolute difference from the published four-decimal composites is 4.9711×10^{-5}. Rebuilding the publication tables uses the retained component records; independently reassessing the calculations also requires the run files and evaluator revision.

S3 CloudraBench task catalogue

CloudraBench comprises 20 Easy, 10 Normal, 10 Hard, and 10 Impossible tasks. Tables S5–S8 list each task's chemistry, charge, multiplicity, conditions, and research question. The machine-readable catalogue contains task names and molecular inputs; the full task definitions also contain atom mappings, prompts, reference graphs, and scoring settings.

Method set A permits xTB, PM7, and B3LYP-D3(BJ)/def2-SVP for Easy, Normal, and Hard tasks. Method set B permits xTB and PM7 for Impossible tasks. Each answer is evaluated under its task's permitted methods. Mechanism tasks request the investigated species and elementary steps as a graph, electronic activation barriers for computed steps, and the corresponding stationary-point and pathway calculations. Stereochemical tasks also require assigning identities from the computed geometries. The tables list each task's specific question in addition to these shared requirements.

For Impossible tasks, the listed quantity or process is the question posed to the agent. A supported conclusion that the answer lies beyond the allowed methods is a valid result. Exploratory values can be labelled as such, and species-property questions are evaluated directly on the species claims.

Table S5. Easy-tier task catalogue. Method set A applies to every task in this table.

ID	Chemical task	Stated conditions and task-specific research target
D1	butadiene + ethylene Diels-Alder (parent DA) Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, 487–648 °C kinetics. *Target:* Cycloaddition pathway, stationary points, and electronic activation barrier.
D3	cyclopentadiene dimerization (self Diels-Alder) Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas/liquid phase, slow at room temperature. *Target:* Dimerization pathway, stationary points, and electronic activation barrier.
D4	cyclopentadiene + acrolein Diels-Alder Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase or hydrocarbon solvent, heated. *Target:* Cycloaddition pathway, stationary points, and electronic activation barrier.
E1	F- + CH3CH2Cl elimination -> ethylene + HF + Cl- Charge -1; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Elimination pathway from the pre-reaction complex, stationary points, and electronic activation barrier.
F1	BH4- + formaldehyde -> borane-methoxide adduct [CH3OBH3]- Charge -1; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Hydride-transfer pathway to the borane–methoxide adduct, stationary points, and electronic barrier.
F4	BH3 + formaldehyde -> methoxyborane via Lewis adduct Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Lewis-adduct-mediated conversion to methoxyborane, with the investigated species and elementary steps.
G2	diimide cis reduction of ethylene Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Reduction pathway, stationary points, and electronic activation barrier.
G3	propylene + ethylene ene reaction (Alder-ene) Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, high temperature. *Target:* Ene-reaction pathway, stationary points, and electronic activation barrier.
L1	cyclobutene -> butadiene ring opening Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, 403-448 K. *Target:* Ring-opening pathway, stationary points, and electronic activation barrier.
L2	hexatriene -> cyclohexadiene ring closure Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, 390-434 K. *Target:* Electrocyclic ring-closure pathway, stationary points, and electronic activation barrier.
M1	2,2'-dimethylbiphenyl aryl-aryl rotation Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Aryl–aryl rotational pathway, connected conformers, and rotational barrier.
M14	acrolein s-trans <-> s-cis rotation Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* s-trans/s-cis conformers, their connecting pathway, and rotational barrier.
M15	HONO cis-trans isomerization Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* cis/trans structures, their connecting pathway, and isomerization barrier.
M16	formic acid dehydrogenation HCOOH -> CO2 + H2 Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Dehydrogenation pathway and electronic activation barrier.
M17	methyl isocyanide -> acetonitrile rearrangement Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Isomerization pathway to acetonitrile and electronic activation barrier.
M3	NH3 umbrella inversion Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Inversion pathway, stationary points, and inversion barrier.
M8	cyclohexane chair flip Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Chair-interconversion pathway, relevant conformers, and barrier.

Continued on the next page

Table S5 (continued)

ID	Chemical task	Stated conditions and task-specific research target
P2	cyclopentadiene degenerate H shift Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase or solution, fast at room temperature. *Target:* Degenerate hydrogen-shift pathway, stationary points, and electronic activation barrier.
P3	allyl vinyl ether Claisen rearrangement Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, $\sim$200 °C. *Target:* Claisen-rearrangement pathway, stationary points, and electronic activation barrier.
X1	beta-propiolactone -> ethylene + CO2 Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, $\sim$350 °C. *Target:* Decomposition pathway to ethylene and carbon dioxide, with stationary points and barrier.

Table S6. Normal-tier task catalogue. Method set A applies to every task in this table.

ID	Chemical task	Stated conditions and task-specific research target
NB1	malonic acid thermal decarboxylation: malonic acid -> acetic acid + CO2 Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas-phase thermolysis. *Target:* Identify intermediates and preserve elementary-step continuity through decarboxylation to the final products.
NI1	imine formation: formaldehyde + methylamine -> N-methylmethanimine + water Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase; optimal around pH 4-6 (bell-shaped rate profile). *Target:* Identify the addition/condensation intermediates and connecting elementary steps leading to the imine and water.
NI5	imine formation (aqueous): formaldehyde + methylamine -> N-methylmethanimine + water Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* aqueous solution, weakly acidic (pH 4-6, bell-shaped rate profile). *Target:* Resolve the aqueous imine-formation network and relevant proton-transfer steps under the stated conditions.
NQ1	aromatic Claisen rearrangement: allyl phenyl ether -> 2-allylphenol Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase; thermal, $\sim$200 °C. *Target:* Resolve rearrangement and subsequent conversion to 2-allylphenol, retaining the intermediate network.
NQ5	oxy-Cope rearrangement: 1,5-hexadien-3-ol -> hex-5-enal ([3,3] then enol-keto tautomerization) Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, heated. *Target:* Resolve the [3,3] rearrangement and enol–keto tautomerization as the investigated network.
NR1	formamide dehydration: formamide -> hydrogen cyanide + water Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* Gas phase; isolated neutral, closed-shell formamide; no added water, acid, or catalyst. *Target:* Investigate formimidic-acid intermediates and conformational transitions in the neutral dehydration network.
NU3	H3P=CH2 ylide + formaldehyde -> ethylene + H3P=O Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* salt-free model conditions (gas-phase ylide, closest to model chemistry). *Target:* Resolve the salt-free model Wittig-reaction network to ethylene and phosphine oxide.
NU5	Passerini reaction: formaldehyde + formic acid + methyl isocyanide -> N-methyl-alpha-formyloxyacetamide Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* dichloromethane (DCM), room temperature, high concentration. *Target:* Resolve the three-component Passerini-reaction network to the specified alpha-acyloxy amide.
NU6	Staudinger beta-lactam synthesis: ketene + methanimine -> 2-azetidinone Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* ketene generated in situ; inert solvent. *Target:* Identify the ketene–imine addition and beta-lactam-forming network, retaining any identified intermediate.
NY3	isocyanic acid hydrolysis: HNCO + one water -> ammonia + carbon dioxide Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* Gas phase; neutral closed-shell system with exactly one water molecule; no added solvent, acid, counterion, or catalyst. *Target:* Investigate carbamic-acid intermediates and connecting conformers without presupposing a fixed number of steps.

Table S7. Hard-tier task catalogue. Method set A applies to every task in this table.

ID	Chemical task	Stated conditions and task-specific research target
HA1	3-methylcyclobutene ring opening: determine the stereochemical outcome Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase or inert solvent, ∼150–200 °C, thermal. *Target:* Determine stereochemical products and channel identities; report channel barriers and the requested relative preference.
HA6	trans-3,4-dimethylcyclobutene ring opening: determine the stereochemical outcome Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase or inert solvent, heating, thermal. *Target:* Determine stereochemical products and channel identities; report channel barriers and the requested relative preference.
HA8	(2E,4Z,6E)-octa-2,4,6-triene thermal 6-pi electrocyclization: determine the stereochemical outcome Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* Gas phase; first thermal ground-state electrocyclization only; no subsequent hydrogen shifts or photochemistry. *Target:* Resolve the product stereochemistry of the first thermal electrocyclization; report investigated channel identities and barriers.
HB1	cyclopentadiene + maleic anhydride Diels-Alder: determine endo/exo outcome Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* benzene, room temperature or mild heating. *Target:* Determine endo/exo products, channel barriers, and relative preference.
HB10	cyclopentadiene + acrylonitrile Diels-Alder reaction: determine both stereochemical pathways Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* Gas phase; concerted addition; common reactant-complex reference for the two channels. *Target:* Compute both endo/exo pathways using a common reactant-complex reference; report identities and barriers.
HD2	cyclohexene oxide + hydroxide: determine the stereochemical outcome of the epoxide opening Charge -1; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* aqueous NaOH, heat. *Target:* Determine the stereochemistry of the epoxide-opening product from the computed structures.
HF1	cyclohex-2-en-1-ol peracid epoxidation: determine the stereochemical outcome Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* performic acid, CH2Cl2, 0–25 °C. *Target:* Determine the two facial pathways, product stereochemistry, barriers, and relative preference.
HH1	1,1'-binaphthyl thermal racemization Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* thermal racemization, ∼50 °C, DMF. *Target:* Characterize the thermal racemization pathway, stereochemical endpoints, and barrier.
HI1	Cope elimination of threo/erythro N,N-dimethyl-3-phenyl-2-butylamine oxide: determine the stereochemical mapping Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* Gas phase; isolated neutral singlet amine oxide. Treat threo and erythro substrates as two separate systems and retain explicit stereochemical SMILES. *Target:* Compute threo and erythro substrates separately; establish substrate CIP assignments and alkene E/Z identity from 3D geometries. Use each substrate's own minimum for its barrier.
HL1	formonitrile oxide + norbornene [3+2] cycloaddition: determine both facial pathways Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* Gas phase; neutral singlet formonitrile oxide and unsubstituted norbornene. Compare approach from both faces relative to the methano bridge. *Target:* Compute both facial approaches relative to the methano bridge and assign products from 3D geometries. Use each channel's own stable contact minimum; report contact-conformer energies separately.

Table S8. Impossible-tier task catalogue. Method set B applies to every task in this table.

ID	Chemical task	Stated conditions and task-specific research target
IA1	cyclobutadiene D4h automerization Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, low temperature (matrix isolation regime). *Target:* Thermal automerization of rectangular cyclobutadiene through the square transition structure: mechanism and activation barrier.
IA5	cyclobutene disrotatory ring opening Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, thermal. *Target:* Thermal disrotatory ring opening of cyclobutene to butadiene: mechanism and activation barrier.
IA7	Bergman cyclization of (Z)-hex-3-ene-1,5-diyne Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, thermal. *Target:* Bergman cyclization to p-benzyne: mechanism and activation barrier.

Continued on the next page

Table S8 (continued)

ID	Chemical task	Stated conditions and task-specific research target
IA9	1,2-dioxetane thermolysis to two formaldehyde Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, thermal. *Target:* Thermolysis of 1,2-dioxetane to two formaldehyde molecules: mechanism and activation barrier.
IB9	diazomethane and ethylene to cyclopropane via 1-pyrazoline Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas-phase thermolysis. *Target:* Conversion of diazomethane and ethylene to cyclopropane and nitrogen through 1-pyrazoline.
IC3	phenylnitrene open-shell singlet state Charge 0; multiplicity 3.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Singlet–triplet energy gap and the electronic character of the lowest phenylnitrene singlet state.
ID2	anomalous bonding in dioxygen difluoride (FOOF) Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase, low temperature. *Target:* Equilibrium F–O and O–O distances of FOOF and its F–O bond-dissociation energy.
IE2	nitrogen triple-bond dissociation curve Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Ground-state N2 dissociation curve and bond-dissociation energy.
IF3	triangulene triplet ground state and singlet-triplet gap Charge 0; multiplicity 3.	*Conditions:* gas phase (surface-synthesis analogue). *Target:* Ground-state spin multiplicity and singlet–triplet gap of triangulene.
IG8	chromium dimer ground-state dissociation curve Charge 0; multiplicity 1.	*Conditions:* gas phase. *Target:* Ground-state Cr2 potential-energy curve and bond-dissociation energy.

S4 Detailed benchmark results and reaction-path analysis

S4.1 Complete workflow and tier comparisons

The dataset contains 200 task runs: one per task under Guided, Standard, Record, and Brief. Each run has a composite and all three component scores. Table S9 reports overall and tier means. Standard uses the same model backbone as Guided; Record removes required physical validation, and Brief shortens diagnostic feedback.

Table S9. Composite and component means for each workflow and task tier.

Tier	Workflow	n	Composite	Graph	SC	Accuracy
All	Guided	50	0.7930	0.8851	0.9233	0.7124
	Standard	50	0.5814	0.7774	0.5303	0.5743
	Record	50	0.6918	0.7813	0.7177	0.6639
	Brief	50	0.7541	0.8493	0.8468	0.6920
Easy	Guided	20	0.9125	0.9778	0.9250	0.8954
	Standard	20	0.6989	0.8849	0.5858	0.7244
	Record	20	0.9128	0.9419	0.9050	0.9118
	Brief	20	0.9370	0.9681	0.9125	0.9440
Normal	Guided	10	0.7370	0.8589	0.9021	0.6342
	Standard	10	0.5731	0.7607	0.5217	0.5675
	Record	10	0.5287	0.6786	0.5783	0.4789
	Brief	10	0.5857	0.7472	0.7740	0.4646
Hard	Guided	10	0.9577	0.9107	0.9542	0.9672
	Standard	10	0.6887	0.8481	0.5033	0.7549
	Record	10	0.8723	0.9243	0.6650	0.9672
	Brief	10	0.8282	0.9286	0.7767	0.8372
Impossible	Guided	10	0.4451	0.7006	0.9100	0.1700
	Standard	10	0.2473	0.5083	0.4550	0.1000
	Record	10	0.2325	0.4200	0.5350	0.0500
	Brief	10	0.4829	0.6345	0.8583	0.2700

SC denotes the graded self-consistency component. Every mean is calculated from the complete publication table. The overall tier weights are 20/50 for Easy and 10/50 for each other tier.

Table S10 gives all six pairwise comparisons on the same 50 tasks. Guided–Standard has a mean difference of 0.211564, a median difference of 0.114200, and 36 task wins, seven losses, and seven ties. The 95% task-bootstrap interval is [0.128988, 0.298537]. Within the Normal tier, the means are 0.737020 and 0.573050, with a difference of 0.163970

[0.036520, 0.292230] and seven wins in ten tasks. Within Hard, the means are 0.957650 and 0.688750; the difference is 0.268900 [0.121300, 0.445930], with Guided higher in all ten task pairs. Easy has means of 0.912520 and 0.698910, with 12 wins, four losses, and four ties; its paired median difference is 0.050000. Impossible has means of 0.445060 and 0.247330 and is examined at the level of the requested target below.

Table S10. All pairwise composite-score comparisons across the 50 tasks.

Comparison	Mean difference	95% interval	W/L/T
Guided–Record	+0.1012	[+0.0396, +0.1695]	28/7/15
Guided–Standard	+0.2116	[+0.1290, +0.2985]	36/7/7
Guided–Brief	+0.0388	[-0.0317, +0.1076]	26/10/14
Record–Standard	+0.1104	[+0.0167, +0.2062]	28/13/9
Record–Brief	-0.0623	[-0.1271, +0.0001]	14/24/12
Standard–Brief	-0.1727	[-0.2713, -0.0762]	11/34/5

The difference is the first workflow minus the second. W/L/T gives the first workflow's task wins, losses, and ties. Percentile task-bootstrap intervals use 100,000 resamples and seed 20261031; the four configurations of each sampled task remain together.

Table S11 decomposes the Guided–Standard difference into weighted score components. Across all tasks, self-consistency contributes +0.117875 and accuracy +0.082916. In Normal and Hard together, the composite difference is +0.216435, including +0.124688 from self-consistency and +0.083712 from accuracy. In Hard, accuracy contributes +0.127391 and self-consistency +0.135250: both the requested answers and the calculations supporting them contribute to the gain.

Table S11. Weighted decomposition of the Guided–Standard composite difference.

Scope	n	Composite	$0.1\Delta G$	$0.3\Delta SC$	$0.6\Delta A$
All	50	+0.211564	+0.010776	+0.117875	+0.082916
Easy	20	+0.213610	+0.009287	+0.101750	+0.102579
Normal	10	+0.163970	+0.009823	+0.114125	+0.040033
Hard	10	+0.268900	+0.006259	+0.135250	+0.127391
Impossible	10	+0.197730	+0.019226	+0.136500	+0.042000
Normal + Hard	20	+0.216435	+0.008041	+0.124688	+0.083712

Component contributions are calculated from the unrounded final components. Composite differences use the four-decimal final scores, so the last displayed digits can differ by score rounding.

Guided–Record averages +0.101156 [0.039606, 0.169478] across all tasks. In Normal and Hard together, its +0.146845 composite difference decomposes into +0.008338 from graph, +0.091938 from self-consistency, and +0.046574 from accuracy. Guided–Brief averages +0.038816 [-0.031704, 0.107648], with mean differences of +0.151350 on Normal and +0.129470 on Hard. Individual multistep tasks differ: NB1 has composite scores of 0.9628, 0.9128, and 0.9900 for Guided, Standard, and Brief; Guided and Brief both have self-consistency 1. NI1 has Guided and Standard composites of 0.9958 and 0.6196, with self-consistency 1 and 0.35. NQ5 favors Record over Guided, while NU3 favors Brief. The leading configuration varies among multistep tasks.

S4.2 Graph delivery and evaluation of the run results

During execution, Guided, Record, and Brief each wrote 50 root mechanism graphs; Standard wrote 43. Standard's remaining seven studies—F1, HA1, HF1, IA9, M17, NR1, and P3—were organized from their own conversations, reports, tool results, and calculation files. The common evaluation procedure thus produced 50 graphs per workflow and 200 complete score profiles, with the source of each recovered field recorded. The recovered graphs give Standard credit for the research documented in these runs. This reduces the Guided–Standard difference compared with scoring by final-file delivery alone.

The seven Standard studies have a mean organized composite of 0.153743, compared with 0.828529 for Guided on the same tasks. They account for 44.7% of the total Guided–Standard difference. Table S12 separately reports self-consistency for the 40 non-Impossible tasks. Guided has 24 full-score records (60.0%) and 16 partial-score records; Standard has seven full-score records (17.5%), 29 partial-score records, and four zero-score records.

S4.3 Elapsed research time and accumulated calculation effort

Table S13 preserves every batch observation from the 48-run repeated-task experiment. A batch contains the same four tasks at a concurrency of two, and its elapsed time spans the batch's actual start and finish. Guided's mean is 4.4514 h, Standard's 3.9577 h, Record's 3.8942 h, and Brief's 4.8273 h. Relative to Standard, Guided's observed mean is 12.5% longer; relative to Brief, it is 7.8% shorter. These observations include waiting, calculation execution, and continuation of the research after results return.

The P2 effort comparison uses the common 15-task set D3, M1, M8, NB1, NQ5, NR1, NU3, NU5, NU6, HA1, HA6,

Table S12. Self-consistency distribution over all 40 non-Impossible tasks.

Workflow	SC = 1	0 < SC < 1	SC = 0	Mean SC
Guided	24	16	0	0.9266
Standard	7	29	4	0.5492
Record	16	24	0	0.7633
Brief	20	20	0	0.8439

This table describes the graded component for the positive-chemistry tiers. The separate scientific-validation record is evaluated from the complete task contract.

Table S13. All 12 elapsed-time observations in the repeated-task study, in hours.

Workflow	Batch 1	Batch 2	Batch 3	Mean
Guided	4.2383	3.8669	5.2489	4.4514
Standard	5.3381	2.5044	4.0306	3.9577
Record	5.4189	2.6203	3.6433	3.8942
Brief	7.2689	3.6475	3.5656	4.8273

Each observation is a four-task batch (E1, NB1, HA1, IA1) at concurrency two. Three batches per workflow contain 48 task runs in total. Batch completion times include the original research lifecycle and outcomes.

HB1, HB10, HD2, and HF1. This yields 60 run-level effort records, with all four configurations represented for each task. Table S14 gives the total and mean job-hours, job counts, terminal outcomes, and corresponding final scores. Recorded ledger durations are summed across quantum-chemical jobs. For Standard/M1, the archived effort reconstruction uses native-log CPU time divided by four, as specified in the source record. The measurement unit throughout this comparison is accumulated job-hours.

Table S14. Recorded quantum-chemical effort on the 15 tasks shared by all configurations.

Workflow	Job-h total	Job-h/task	Jobs	Failed	Cancelled	Mean S
Guided	166.19	11.079	789	114	94	0.8124
Standard	113.32	7.555	419	45	50	0.6495
Record	118.16	7.877	431	62	38	0.7360
Brief	233.85	15.590	883	167	120	0.7273

Each workflow contributes 15 task runs. Job-hours sum recorded process durations. Failed and cancelled jobs are separate terminal categories. Job counts measure execution effort; scientific validation is assessed from the calculation results.

Guided used a mean of 11.0793 job-hours and obtained a mean composite of 0.812413. Relative to Standard, it used 46.7% more job time and scored 0.162933 higher; relative to Brief, it used 28.9% less job time and scored 0.085080 higher. Guided had both a higher score and lower job time than Brief on seven of the 15 paired tasks. Guided recorded 789 jobs, including 114 failures and 94 cancellations; Brief recorded 883 jobs, including 167 failures and 120 cancellations. In the wider 63-run archive, NU3, NU5, NU6, and NR1 account for 163.5 of 673.82 job-hours across their 16 runs. These trajectories record repeated searches for the required intermediates and connecting pathways.

S4.4 Conformer references and reaction-step assignments

Table S15 gives all score components for the following cases. We examine which reactant conformer defines each barrier and which reaction step each optimized saddle connects.

Table S15. Complete score profiles for the four scientific-attribution cases.

Task	Workflow	Composite	Graph	SC	Accuracy
HA8	Guided	0.9625	1.0000	0.8750	1.0000
	Standard	0.6250	1.0000	0.3500	0.7000
HH1	Guided	0.9838	1.0000	1.0000	0.9731
	Standard	0.8338	1.0000	0.5000	0.9731
HI1	Guided	0.9999	0.9992	1.0000	1.0000
	Standard	0.7032	0.3325	0.2333	1.0000
NU6	Guided	0.6719	1.0000	0.9375	0.4844
	Standard	0.6892	0.8167	0.6250	0.7000

These profiles retain the distinct contributions of pathway coverage, evidence support, and agreement with the requested answer.

HA8: stable reactant reference and reactive conformer. Guided reports 29.46 kcal/mol and Standard 20.43 kcal/mol, against a reference of 29.48 kcal/mol. Their 9.03 kcal/mol difference comes from the reactant energy: Guided uses the

lowest all-s-trans minimum, whereas Standard uses a reactive cisoid conformer. The IRC identifies the local conformer connected to the saddle; the task's barrier is measured from the specified stable reactant minimum. The two references can therefore be different conformers.

HH1: the same barrier with different IRC support. Both workflows report a binaphthyl racemization barrier of 23.48 kcal/mol; the reference is 23.01 kcal/mol. Their accuracy components are 0.973067 and 0.973064 and both graph components are 1. Guided has self-consistency 1, whereas Standard has 0.5. Their composites are consequently 0.9838 and 0.8338. Standard's archive contains candidate channels and IRC inputs; Guided completes the required chain from the saddle through the IRC to the endpoint calculations. This difference in path support contributes 0.1500 to the composite despite the matching barriers.

HI1: numerical agreement with different species and path coverage. Guided and Standard both have accuracy approximately 1. Their graph components are 0.999176 and 0.332509, and self-consistency components are 1 and 0.233333. The corresponding composites are 0.9999 and 0.7032. Matching numerical accuracy thus accompanies different coverage of the requested species, steps, and path calculations.

NU6: the optimized saddle and the intended second step. The Guided record gives $E_{\mathrm{TS}} = -247.030042392$ Ha for its concerted saddle region and $E_{\mathrm{betaine}} = -247.060060699$ Ha. Using 627.5094740631 kcal mol^{-1} Ha^{-1} gives

$$[E_{\mathrm{TS}} - E_{\mathrm{betaine}}]\ 627.5094740631 = 18.836772\ \mathrm{kcal\,mol^{-1}}. \tag{S6}$$

Standard reports 18.837 kcal/mol as the second-step ring-closure barrier. Guided leaves the betaine-to-product ring-closure saddle unresolved and describes the energy difference relative to the concerted saddle region. Its searches from interpolated betaine geometries and constrained-scan peaks repeatedly return toward the direct reactant-to-product saddle region. Assigning the energy difference to an elementary step therefore requires identifying the optimized saddle and its actual endpoints.

S4.5 Impossible-tier results and the requested negative conclusions

Table S16 resolves Brief's mean composite of 0.482940 and Guided's 0.445060 into all ten task differences. Brief is higher on three tasks, Guided on five, and two tie. The Brief-minus-Guided mean is +0.037880, with the existing task-bootstrap interval $[-0.188220, 0.283970]$. Its weighted contributions are -0.006607 from graph, -0.015500 from self-consistency, and +0.060000 from accuracy. IA1 and IA9 provide the two large positive differences, while IG8 has the opposite accuracy ordering. Across the seven tasks with equal accuracy components in these two workflows, Brief-minus-Guided averages -0.050000.

Table S16. Task-resolved comparison of Brief and Guided in the Impossible tier.

Task	Guided C	Brief C	Brief − Guided	Guided A	Brief A
IA1	0.1717	1.0000	+0.8283	0.0	1.0
IA5	0.4000	0.3667	-0.0333	0.0	0.0
IA7	0.2583	0.2583	+0.0000	0.0	0.0
IA9	0.3667	0.9333	+0.5666	0.0	1.0
IB9	0.8200	0.7700	-0.0500	0.7	0.7
IC3	0.4000	0.4000	+0.0000	0.0	0.0
ID2	0.3339	0.1839	-0.1500	0.0	0.0
IE2	0.3333	0.1833	-0.1500	0.0	0.0
IF3	0.3667	0.4000	+0.0333	0.0	0.0
IG8	1.0000	0.3339	-0.6661	1.0	0.0

C denotes the composite and A the accuracy component for the task-defined numerical or negative target. All values are retained from the publication score table.

Brief reaches accuracy 1 for IA1, the square-geometry cyclobutadiene automerization target, and IA9, dioxetane thermolysis. Guided reaches accuracy 1 for IG8, the chromium-dimer target. Both have accuracy 0.7 in IB9, which contains positive and negative target components. Across all 40 Impossible runs, four have accuracy 1 and 14 have self-consistency 1 with accuracy 0. The following cases show why local calculation support and the conclusion about the requested state or pathway can score differently.

The preserved Brief/IC3 graph identifies the requested lowest open-shell singlet $^1A_2$ as inaccessible under the permitted route, marks its state-change edge accordingly, and withholds the requested singlet–triplet gap. It retains a separately characterized closed-shell $^1A_1$ branch. The PM7 value of +45.9 kcal/mol and GFN2-xTB value of -1.7 kcal/mol are labelled as exploratory relative energies for that branch, outside the requested gap. The mixed initial guess was used in a restricted calculation; the requested unrestricted electronic state remains untested. The final profile is Graph/SC/Accuracy = 1/1/0 and composite 0.4.

Record/IA5 distinguishes the requested disrotatory ring opening from an allowed conrotatory path. It marks the disrotatory edge inaccessible and reports the conrotatory path separately at 33.57 kcal/mol. The evaluation notes show that the matcher selected the positive path because it shared the endpoints, leaving accuracy at 0. Both the agent's stated conclusions and the scores used in the analysis are retained.

S4.6 Easy-tier energy references and delivery trajectories

These five Easy cases examine the reactant energy used for a barrier, the chemical identity assigned to a graph node, and whether calculated values remain in the final graph. We read each run's final graph, native calculation logs, evaluation notes, and runtime events. Table S17 reports the final scores. SC_{all} grades every delivered graph element, including additions to Gold; SC_{Gold} grades only the reference-matched subgraph. The composite uses SC_{all}.

Table S17. Final component scores for the five inspected Easy tasks, rounded to four decimal places. Brief denotes Brief-errors. The two SC columns retain their separate assessment scopes. Accuracy is the final component after reference matching and the specified numerical penalty cap.

Task	Workflow	Graph	SC_{all}	SC_{Gold}	Accuracy	Composite
F4	Guided	0.9167	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000	0.9917
	Standard	0.5176	0.7500	0.0000	0.0000	0.2768
	Record	0.6009	0.7500	0.0000	0.0000	0.2851
	Brief	0.9167	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000	0.9917
G2	Guided	0.8889	0.5000	0.5000	0.0000	0.2389
	Standard	1.0000	0.5000	0.5000	0.8782	0.7769
	Record	1.0000	0.5000	0.5000	0.8782	0.7769
	Brief	1.0000	0.5000	0.5000	1.0000	0.8500
D1	Guided	1.0000	1.0000	1.0000	0.7000	0.8200
	Standard	0.7917	0.5000	0.5000	1.0000	0.8291
	Record	0.7917	1.0000	1.0000	0.7000	0.7992
	Brief	1.0000	0.7500	0.7500	0.7000	0.7450
D3	Guided	1.0000	0.7500	0.7500	0.7000	0.7450
	Standard	1.0000	0.7500	0.7500	0.9995	0.9247
	Record	0.9444	0.3500	0.3500	0.9909	0.7940
	Brief	0.8333	0.7500	0.7500	0.7000	0.7283
L2	Guided	1.0000	0.7500	0.7500	0.7000	0.7450
	Standard	1.0000	0.5000	0.5000	0.7000	0.6700
	Record	1.0000	0.7500	0.7500	0.8832	0.8549
	Brief	1.0000	0.8333	0.7500	0.8832	0.8799

F4: adduct identity in the final mechanism graph. Guided reported hydride transfer from the Lewis adduct of borane and formaldehyde to methoxyborane. Its linked reactant and saddle calculations gave energies of -141.041124115 and -141.015601446 hartree, a barrier of 16.01572 kcal mol^{-1} supporting the declared 16.02. Independent saddle frequency analysis found one imaginary frequency, -398.7218 cm^{-1}. Optimizations starting from both actual IRC outer frames converged to the corresponding endpoint minima with zero imaginary frequencies. All four workflows obtained essentially the same saddle and adduct energies.

The F4 reference specifies hydride transfer from the bonded Lewis adduct, `[BH3-][O+]=C`, with a 16.02-kcal mol^{-1} barrier. Guided and Brief named this adduct in their final graphs and obtained Accuracy close to 1. Standard and Record kept the separated-fragment representation `[BH3].C=O` for the reactant node. This failed to match the reference adduct and received Accuracy 0, although the native calculations supported essentially the same pathway.

G2: computed evidence and final structured delivery. Guided's native logs contain a concerted double-H-transfer saddle at -189.093172517 hartree with one imaginary frequency, -444.9504 cm^{-1}. The optimized cis reactant complex and the IRC-derived reactant minimum have energies of -189.094518484 and -189.094518735 hartree. They give barriers of 0.84461 and 0.84476 kcal mol^{-1}, respectively, close to the 0.87 reference.

The program rejected a numerical barrier on a companion complex-product edge four times because its scientific checks remained open. Meanwhile, reports for the selected separated-products target returned `complete=true` with all targets marked resolved. After an initial deletion, the Supervisor asked the agent to restore all numerical barriers and the saddle's energy/log fields. After the fourth rejection, the agent deleted the companion-edge values. A subsequent artifact check rejected the saddle-evidence claim; the next edit removed the selected edge's remaining barrier and the saddle's energy/log fields. The saved write and program output confirm these deletions. The final graph kept the values in descriptive text, but the numerical target received Accuracy 0. Its graded SC contribution remained 0.5.

Brief retained a numerical barrier of 0.844 and obtained Accuracy 0.99999. Standard and Record declared approximately 3.4 using a lower-energy reactant reference; Record's native report identifies this as a trans-diimide stack and separately records the approximately 0.84 cis-reference result.

D1 and D3: numerical penalties with different physical origins. The evaluation notes explicitly attribute Accuracy 0.7 to the maximum numerical-deviation penalty of 0.3. For D1, 15.738 versus 18.830 kcal mol^{-1} gives an underlying Gaussian score of 0.5880 before this cap. Guided and Standard obtained nearly identical saddle energies, but their reactant energies differ by 3.11859 kcal mol^{-1}. Their butadiene dihedrals are approximately $26.33°$ and $-179.93°$, corresponding to reactive s-cis and lower s-trans references. Record also delivered the s-cis barrier and retained SC 1 with Accuracy 0.7.

In D3, Guided and Standard reported barriers of 18.14687 and 14.55472 kcal mol^{-1}. Their reactant energies differ by only 0.09899 kcal mol^{-1}, whereas their saddle energies differ by 3.69113 kcal mol^{-1}. Both saddle logs contain exactly one imaginary frequency. Both evaluations assign SC 0.75 and warn about the product-endpoint association; the numerical barrier difference determines the capped Accuracy score.

L2: two reference barriers and the selected comparison edge. Guided used the reactive cZc minimum and obtained 18.98740 kcal mol^{-1}; its graph states that the stable-to-reactive conformer contribution was uncomputed. Record and Brief used the lower tZt reference, giving approximately 28.275. The conformer energy difference is 9.28761 kcal mol^{-1}.

Standard delivered both references and both barriers: 18.99 on edge `e1` and 28.28 on `e2`. The archived evaluation selected `e1`. Both candidates have identical bond-change lists, and the unspecified-stereochemistry reference gives equal endpoint substitution costs for these reactants. The final edge-identifier tie-break selects `e1`, so the local-reference value receives the capped Accuracy 0.7. Standard's final report explicitly contains the stable-reference barrier and conformer gap.

S4.7 Sensitivity to target-object assignment in Impossible tasks

Record/IA5 and Brief/IC3 distinguish pathways or electronic states that share the same endpoint connectivity. Using their original final graphs and process records, we calculated how the Impossible-tier means would change if the existing negative-credit rule were applied to the requested pathway or state. The 200-run evaluation table remains the reported dataset; these conditional results are listed separately. Graph and Self-consistency remain fixed in both cases, as do all scores for the other 198 runs.

IA5 requests the thermal disrotatory ring opening of cyclobutene. Record's final graph marks the disrotatory edge `e_dis` and its transition-state node inaccessible, leaving its barrier unspecified. A separate conrotatory edge, `e_con`, carries a barrier of 33.57 kcal/mol. The final process record explicitly distinguishes the requested disrotatory target from this computed alternative. Both edges have the same connectivity endpoints and bond-change signature; identifying the requested pathway also requires the conrotatory/disrotatory distinction.

IC3 requests the lowest singlet state of phenylnitrene and its singlet–triplet gap. Brief's original graph distinguishes the closed-shell singlet `S1_1A1` from the open-shell target `S2_1A2`. It marks the latter node and its state-change edge inaccessible, withholds the requested numerical gap, and explicitly excludes the closed-shell branch's relative energies from that gap. The two state-change edges again have identical endpoint SMILES and bond-change signatures. The final baseline for Brief/IC3 has Graph $= 1$, Self-consistency $= 1$, Accuracy $= 0$, and composite $= 0.4$.

In both graphs, the matcher selects the positive alternative pathway or state. Matching the requested negative target to its reference would earn credit under the unchanged negative-claim rule. A correction must first use the run's final statements to distinguish the requested pathway or state from the positive alternative. It must also retain any contradictory positive claim about that same target.

Both cases in the final evaluation have Graph $= 1$, Self-consistency $= 1$, Accuracy $= 0$, and composite $= 0.4$. Assigning Accuracy $= 1$ to either intended negative target changes that case's conditional composite by 0.6, following the fixed Accuracy weight. Its configuration's ten-task Impossible mean therefore increases by 0.06000. Table S18 reports the four scenarios; the accompanying `matcher_sensitivity_scenarios.csv` retains their configuration-level means and ranks.

Table S18. Impossible-tier mean composite scores under two conditional target-assignment corrections. Only the indicated Accuracy values change; Graph, Self-consistency, and the other 198 runs remain fixed. The baseline row gives the final evaluation values.

Scenario	Guided	Standard	Record	Brief
Final evaluation values	0.44506	0.24733	0.23250	0.48294
Record/IA5 target credit	0.44506	0.24733	0.29250	0.48294
Brief/IC3 target credit	0.44506	0.24733	0.23250	0.54294
Both target credits	0.44506	0.24733	0.29250	0.54294

The Impossible-tier ordering Brief $>$ Guided $>$ Record remains the same in all scenarios. Crediting Record's IA5 target moves Record above Standard; crediting Brief's IC3 target leaves Brief first. These assignments can therefore reverse the

Record–Standard ordering while preserving every Guided–Standard score, paired difference, and primary comparison. The calculations apply the two stated score substitutions; the final evaluation table and scientific-validation results remain frozen.

S4.8 Discussion of the supplementary comparisons

The Normal and Hard cases show what the DAG must keep track of during a mechanism study: which species and conformers have been found, which pathways connect them, and which reactant energy defines each reported barrier. Agents use these accumulated results to choose new geometries, continue a path calculation, or revise a proposed step. Keeping them in the DAG supports these choices across successive model calls, complementing external planning and tool feedback.[20–22] HA8 requires correcting the reactant reference; NU6 requires recognizing that a search has returned to a different saddle region.

P2 retains one run per task and configuration. Its task-cluster bootstrap intervals measure variation across the sampled tasks. P1b supplies three repeats on each of four tasks under each configuration; these 48 runs provide repeat measurements on those four tasks within the 50-task P2 study. The P2 table includes all 200 runs and their three components. Some Hard tasks score qualitative channel identity, so the gain includes pathway identification and completion of the supporting calculations as well as numerical barriers. Repeating the full task set would measure run-to-run variation and how often the agents select each route.

The Impossible rubric concerns targets judged physically nonexistent under the specified permitted methods; self-consistency credit records the supported negative conclusion. A positive step requires its own TS–IRC–endpoint chain. IA5 and IC3 require matching the requested pathway and electronic state before scoring the answer. Brief's crossed outcomes suggest task-dependent effects of diagnostic content; the causal effect of diagnostic length remains unmeasured. In NU6, the matching energy difference prompts a check of the assigned step. The native geometries and paths determine whether two calculations found the same saddle.

Timing comparisons use batch elapsed time for P1b and accumulated job-hours for P2. Separate measurements of queueing, calculation, agent-active time, and end-to-end P2 latency remain future work.

Cloudra's default preorganization samples 32 rigid relative placements, relaxes them with MMFF94, and selects candidates by energy and clustering. It samples local arrangements; global-minimum coverage requires a separate assessment. CREST is an optional backend, and its coverage across the 200 runs remains to be established. Flexible systems may need broader sampling and more quantum-chemical calculations. Further work should measure which conformers are found and how calculations can be allocated among competing candidates.

The benchmark scores electronic energy differences alone; zero-point, thermal/entropic, standard-state, and solvation free-energy contributions remain outside this comparison. NI5 specifies weakly acidic aqueous solution, and NU5 specifies dichloromethane at high concentration; both are scored against the prescribed electronic-energy references. Solution-phase free-energy barriers and solvent sensitivity, including the magnitude and direction of solvent effects, remain unassessed.

All workflow comparisons used the same atom-mapping coefficients and ambiguity window, and the same branch-crowding decay, depth, and congestion settings. Their individual effects remain unmeasured. The imaginary-mode alignment ratio of 0.5 is advisory; physical validation uses the stationary-point and IRC/endpoint calculations. All P2 configurations used DeepSeek-v4.1-flash (1017), the API alias `deepseek-v4-flash`, and the recorded request settings. Additional backbones would test whether the workflow improvements extend to other models.

The Easy cases show two different problems. In F4, the final graphs assign different reactant identities despite calculations supporting essentially the same pathway. In G2, validation feedback prompts deletion of structured numerical fields while the values remain in prose. Recording validation status separately would let the agent state a quantity's scientific qualification while retaining the quantity and its source. The conditional IA5/IC3 analysis changes which pathway or electronic state is scored while keeping the validation rules and final publication dataset fixed.

S4.9 Complete per-task and per-configuration scores

Tables S19–S22 report all 200 runs and all four reported quantities, comprising 200 composite scores and 600 component values. Standard is the primary comparison using the same model backbone; Record and Brief are workflow ablations. Every task has one result for each configuration.

Composite scores are displayed to four decimal places and component scores to six decimal places. The accompanying `cloudrabench_200_run_scores.csv` retains the original full-precision numeric strings. Accordingly, recomputing the weighted composite from the displayed component values can differ from the separately rounded composite in the last shown digit. The printed scientific self-consistency score is the graded component, distinct from the separate all-or-none scientific acceptance decision.

Table S19. Complete Easy-tier results for all four configurations. S: composite score; G: graph structure; SC: scientific self-consistency score; A: accuracy.

Task	Configuration	S	G	SC	A
D1	Guided	0.8200	1.000000	1.000000	0.700000
D1	Standard	0.8291	0.791667	0.500000	0.999960
D1	Record	0.7992	0.791667	1.000000	0.700000
D1	Brief	0.7450	1.000000	0.750000	0.700000
D3	Guided	0.7450	1.000000	0.750000	0.700000
D3	Standard	0.9247	1.000000	0.750000	0.999496
D3	Record	0.7940	0.944444	0.350000	0.990939
D3	Brief	0.7283	0.833333	0.750000	0.700000
D4	Guided	0.9250	1.000000	0.750000	0.999982
D4	Standard	0.8500	1.000000	0.500000	0.999982
D4	Record	0.9104	1.000000	0.750000	0.975699
D4	Brief	0.9049	0.944444	0.750000	0.975698
E1	Guided	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999972
E1	Standard	0.7828	0.777778	0.350000	0.999973
E1	Record	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999973
E1	Brief	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999973
F1	Guided	0.9417	0.916667	0.833333	1.000000
F1	Standard	0.0333	0.333333	0.000000	0.000000
F1	Record	0.9917	0.916667	1.000000	1.000000
F1	Brief	0.9117	0.916667	0.750000	0.991654
F4	Guided	0.9917	0.916667	1.000000	0.999999
F4	Standard	0.2768	0.517569	0.750000	0.000000
F4	Record	0.2851	0.600902	0.750000	0.000000
F4	Brief	0.9917	0.916667	1.000000	0.999999
G2	Guided	0.2389	0.888889	0.500000	0.000000
G2	Standard	0.7769	1.000000	0.500000	0.878159
G2	Record	0.7769	1.000000	0.500000	0.878161
G2	Brief	0.8500	1.000000	0.500000	0.999986
G3	Guided	0.9832	0.833333	1.000000	0.999830
G3	Standard	0.1417	0.666667	0.250000	0.000000
G3	Record	0.9832	0.833333	1.000000	0.999830
G3	Brief	0.9749	0.750000	1.000000	0.999833
L1	Guided	0.9999	1.000000	1.000000	0.999899
L1	Standard	0.9749	1.000000	0.916667	0.999900
L1	Record	0.9999	1.000000	1.000000	0.999900
L1	Brief	0.9999	1.000000	1.000000	0.999899
L2	Guided	0.7450	1.000000	0.750000	0.700000
L2	Standard	0.6700	1.000000	0.500000	0.700000
L2	Record	0.8549	1.000000	0.750000	0.883231
L2	Brief	0.8799	1.000000	0.833333	0.883239
M1	Guided	0.9478	1.000000	1.000000	0.913062
M1	Standard	0.7526	1.000000	0.350000	0.912639
M1	Record	0.9476	1.000000	1.000000	0.912639
M1	Brief	0.9476	1.000000	1.000000	0.912638
M14	Guided	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	1.000000
M14	Standard	0.8050	1.000000	0.350000	1.000000
M14	Record	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	1.000000
M14	Brief	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	1.000000
M15	Guided	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999999
M15	Standard	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999999
M15	Record	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999983
M15	Brief	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999999
M16	Guided	0.9748	1.000000	0.916667	0.999691
M16	Standard	0.9998	1.000000	1.000000	0.999692
M16	Record	0.9915	0.916667	1.000000	0.999694

Continued on the next page

Table S19 (continued)

Task	Configuration	S	G	SC	A
M16	Brief	0.9998	1.000000	1.000000	0.999692
M17	Guided	0.9999	1.000000	1.000000	0.999914
M17	Standard	0.0778	0.777778	0.000000	0.000000
M17	Record	0.9999	1.000000	1.000000	0.999914
M17	Brief	0.9999	1.000000	1.000000	0.999914
M3	Guided	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999996
M3	Standard	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999996
M3	Record	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999996
M3	Brief	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999996
M8	Guided	0.9996	1.000000	1.000000	0.999335
M8	Standard	0.9996	1.000000	1.000000	0.999339
M8	Record	0.9996	1.000000	1.000000	0.999294
M8	Brief	0.9996	1.000000	1.000000	0.999294
P2	Guided	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999948
P2	Standard	0.9833	0.833333	1.000000	0.999947
P2	Record	0.9833	0.833333	1.000000	0.999947
P2	Brief	0.9750	1.000000	0.916667	0.999947
P3	Guided	0.9380	1.000000	1.000000	0.896739
P3	Standard	0.1000	1.000000	0.000000	0.000000
P3	Record	0.9380	1.000000	1.000000	0.896735
P3	Brief	0.8309	1.000000	1.000000	0.718109
X1	Guided	0.9999	1.000000	1.000000	0.999916
X1	Standard	0.9999	1.000000	1.000000	0.999914
X1	Record	0.9999	1.000000	1.000000	0.999916
X1	Brief	0.9999	1.000000	1.000000	0.999914

Table S20. Complete Normal-tier results for all four configurations. S: composite score; G: graph structure; SC: scientific self-consistency score; A: accuracy.

Task	Configuration	S	G	SC	A
NB1	Guided	0.9628	0.628571	1.000000	0.999972
NB1	Standard	0.9128	0.628571	0.833333	0.999970
NB1	Record	0.8625	0.600000	0.675000	0.999972
NB1	Brief	0.9900	0.900000	1.000000	0.999972
NI1	Guided	0.9958	1.000000	1.000000	0.993046
NI1	Standard	0.6196	0.946119	0.350000	0.700000
NI1	Record	0.7767	0.816667	0.916667	0.700000
NI1	Brief	0.9889	1.000000	1.000000	0.981480
NI5	Guided	0.7715	0.928571	1.000000	0.631094
NI5	Standard	0.3136	0.571429	0.675000	0.089878
NI5	Record	0.1542	0.442375	0.366667	0.000000
NI5	Brief	0.3571	0.571429	1.000000	0.000000
NQ1	Guided	0.7395	0.945455	0.750000	0.700000
NQ1	Standard	0.9040	0.797980	0.750000	0.998691
NQ1	Record	0.7131	0.680808	0.750000	0.700000
NQ1	Brief	0.1731	0.680808	0.350000	0.000000
NQ5	Guided	0.7075	1.000000	0.625000	0.700000
NQ5	Standard	0.7510	0.920000	0.550000	0.823369
NQ5	Record	0.8725	1.000000	0.625000	0.974999
NQ5	Brief	0.7810	1.000000	0.625000	0.822502
NR1	Guided	0.6167	0.666667	0.833333	0.500000
NR1	Standard	0.1643	0.592593	0.350000	0.000002
NR1	Record	0.5378	0.777778	0.533333	0.500000
NR1	Brief	0.6142	0.666667	0.875000	0.475000
NU3	Guided	0.5527	0.776832	0.916667	0.333330
NU3	Standard	0.3621	0.571429	0.350000	0.333330

Continued on the next page

Table S20 (continued)

Task	Configuration	S	G	SC	A
NU3	Record	0.4071	0.571429	0.500000	0.333330
NU3	Brief	0.6829	0.828571	0.666667	0.666657
NU5	Guided	0.3518	0.642857	0.958333	0.000000
NU5	Standard	0.2654	0.904762	0.116667	0.233136
NU5	Record	0.2966	0.779762	0.233333	0.247741
NU5	Brief	0.1983	0.662546	0.440000	0.000000
NU6	Guided	0.6719	1.000000	0.937500	0.484393
NU6	Standard	0.6892	0.816667	0.625000	0.700000
NU6	Record	0.1450	0.400000	0.350000	0.000000
NU6	Brief	0.3400	0.400000	1.000000	0.000000
NY3	Guided	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	0.999998
NY3	Standard	0.7485	0.857143	0.616667	0.796239
NY3	Record	0.5217	0.716855	0.833333	0.333333
NY3	Brief	0.7312	0.761905	0.783333	0.700000

Table S21. Complete Hard-tier results for all four configurations. S: composite score; G: graph structure; SC: scientific self-consistency score; A: accuracy.

Task	Configuration	S	G	SC	A
HA1	Guided	0.9625	1.000000	0.875000	1.000000
HA1	Standard	0.1000	1.000000	0.000000	0.000000
HA1	Record	0.9250	1.000000	0.750000	1.000000
HA1	Brief	0.9250	1.000000	0.750000	1.000000
HA6	Guided	0.9750	1.000000	0.916667	1.000000
HA6	Standard	0.9625	1.000000	0.875000	1.000000
HA6	Record	0.9750	1.000000	0.916667	1.000000
HA6	Brief	0.9750	1.000000	0.916667	1.000000
HA8	Guided	0.9625	1.000000	0.875000	0.999961
HA8	Standard	0.6250	1.000000	0.350000	0.700000
HA8	Record	0.9250	1.000000	0.750000	0.999961
HA8	Brief	0.7450	1.000000	0.750000	0.700000
HB1	Guided	0.9325	0.700000	0.875000	1.000000
HB1	Standard	0.8250	0.750000	0.500000	1.000000
HB1	Record	0.9700	0.700000	1.000000	1.000000
HB1	Brief	0.9800	0.800000	1.000000	1.000000
HB10	Guided	0.9995	1.000000	1.000000	0.999225
HB10	Standard	0.9928	0.932344	1.000000	0.999217
HB10	Record	0.8044	0.999011	0.350000	0.999226
HB10	Brief	0.7845	0.800000	0.350000	0.999239
HD2	Guided	0.7867	0.666667	1.000000	0.700000
HD2	Standard	0.6977	0.666667	0.350000	0.876795
HD2	Record	0.5950	1.000000	0.250000	0.700000
HD2	Brief	0.6699	0.999176	0.500000	0.700000
HF1	Guided	0.9742	0.741868	1.000000	1.000000
HF1	Standard	0.3425	0.799505	0.875000	0.000000
HF1	Record	0.9072	0.821728	0.750000	1.000000
HF1	Brief	0.2937	0.687405	0.750000	0.000000
HH1	Guided	0.9838	1.000000	1.000000	0.973067
HH1	Standard	0.8338	1.000000	0.500000	0.973064
HH1	Record	0.7888	1.000000	0.350000	0.973066
HH1	Brief	0.9838	1.000000	1.000000	0.973066
HI1	Guided	0.9999	0.999176	1.000000	0.999998
HI1	Standard	0.7032	0.332509	0.233333	0.999998
HI1	Record	0.9350	0.999588	0.783333	0.999998
HI1	Brief	0.9999	0.999176	1.000000	0.999998
HL1	Guided	0.9999	0.999176	1.000000	0.999999

Continued on the next page

Table S21 (continued)

Task	Configuration	S	G	SC	A
HL1	Standard	0.8050	1.000000	0.350000	0.999999
HL1	Record	0.8972	0.722222	0.750000	0.999995
HL1	Brief	0.9250	1.000000	0.750000	0.999999

Table S22. Complete Impossible-tier results for all four configurations. S: composite score; G: graph structure; SC: scientific self-consistency score; A: accuracy.

Task	Configuration	S	G	SC	A
IA1	Guided	0.1717	0.666667	0.350000	0.000000
IA1	Standard	0.1717	0.666667	0.350000	0.000000
IA1	Record	0.1717	0.666667	0.350000	0.000000
IA1	Brief	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	1.000000
IA5	Guided	0.4000	1.000000	1.000000	0.000000
IA5	Standard	0.1417	0.666667	0.250000	0.000000
IA5	Record	0.4000	1.000000	1.000000	0.000000
IA5	Brief	0.3667	0.666667	1.000000	0.000000
IA7	Guided	0.2583	0.333333	0.750000	0.000000
IA7	Standard	0.1383	0.333333	0.350000	0.000000
IA7	Record	0.2583	0.333333	0.750000	0.000000
IA7	Brief	0.2583	0.333333	0.750000	0.000000
IA9	Guided	0.3667	0.666667	1.000000	0.000000
IA9	Standard	0.2583	0.333333	0.750000	0.000000
IA9	Record	0.3667	0.666667	1.000000	0.000000
IA9	Brief	0.9333	0.333333	1.000000	1.000000
IB9	Guided	0.8200	1.000000	1.000000	0.700000
IB9	Standard	0.1800	0.750000	0.350000	0.000000
IB9	Record	0.5450	0.200000	0.750000	0.500000
IB9	Brief	0.7700	1.000000	0.833333	0.700000
IC3	Guided	0.4000	1.000000	1.000000	0.000000
IC3	Standard	0.1833	0.333333	0.500000	0.000000
IC3	Record	0.2167	0.666667	0.500000	0.000000
IC3	Brief	0.4000	1.000000	1.000000	0.000000
ID2	Guided	0.3339	0.339244	1.000000	0.000000
ID2	Standard	0.0000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
ID2	Record	0.0000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
ID2	Brief	0.1839	0.339244	0.500000	0.000000
IE2	Guided	0.3333	0.333333	1.000000	0.000000
IE2	Standard	0.0333	0.333333	0.000000	0.000000
IE2	Record	0.0333	0.333333	0.000000	0.000000
IE2	Brief	0.1833	0.333333	0.500000	0.000000
IF3	Guided	0.3667	0.666667	1.000000	0.000000
IF3	Standard	0.3667	0.666667	1.000000	0.000000
IF3	Record	0.3333	0.333333	1.000000	0.000000
IF3	Brief	0.4000	1.000000	1.000000	0.000000
IG8	Guided	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	1.000000
IG8	Standard	1.0000	1.000000	1.000000	1.000000
IG8	Record	0.0000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
IG8	Brief	0.3339	0.339329	1.000000	0.000000

S4.10 Expanded task-score matrices

The two vector panels below expand the complete per-task score view for reading alongside the exact values in Tables S19–S22. Both use the same color scale and configuration order as the manuscript.

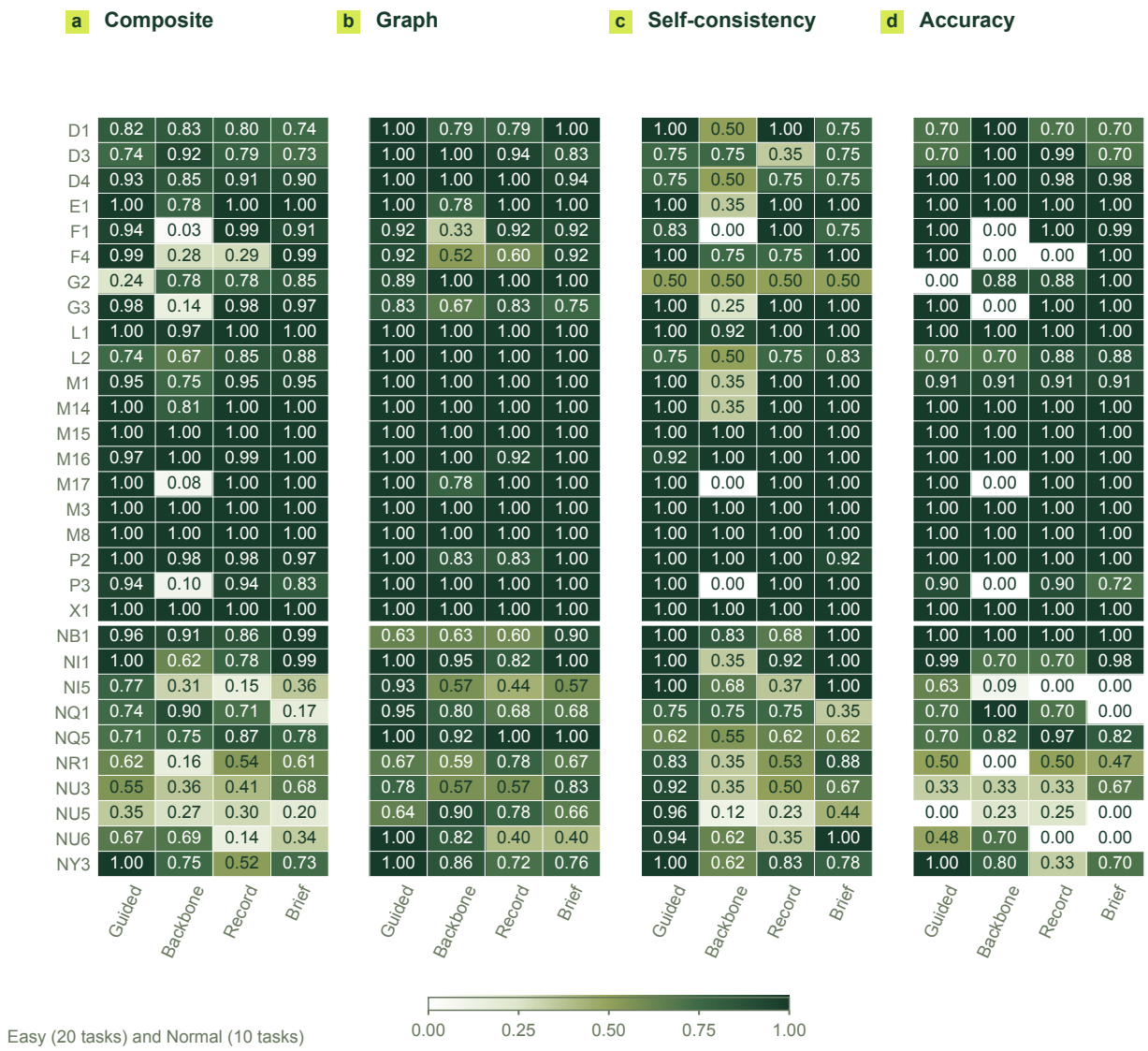


Figure S1. All Easy and Normal task scores. Each task has four configuration rows and four score layers: composite, graph, scientific self-consistency, and accuracy. Cells are rounded to two decimals; the preceding tables and companion CSV retain greater precision. Backbone denotes Standard.

S5 Behavioral diagnostics and archived research trajectories

S5.1 Study materials and local inference settings

We examined Cloudra's recorded research trajectories and constructed local questions about the molecules, geometries, and calculations in them. The trajectories retain the original model statements, tool inputs and outputs, and subsequent actions. The local tests vary which information the model receives and the order of its answer options. The supplementary data contain every question, expected answer, actual answer, request configuration, and source identifier.

The local deployment was archived as `qwen3.8:27b`, using a GGUF Q4_K_M quantization with a reported parameter size of 27.3B. The deployment digest is

`22130167c4c20e20c7b71454612966ca8e8171e9b3cc8ab6ce8aa6cbfec79643.`

The local API reports a maximum context of 262,144 tokens. The short diagnostic requests use an 8,192-token context. Temperature is 0, seed 42, top-k 0, top-p 1, minimum-p 0, repeat penalty 1, presence penalty 0, and draft prediction count 0. The initial identity and evidence-binding tests use the saved explicit ChatML rendering, an empty thinking block, thinking disabled, and a maximum of eight generated tokens; top-20 token log probabilities are retained. Native-chat controls use separate system and user messages, the model's native rendering, and a maximum of 1,024 generated tokens. The thinking setting is recorded for each request. A final choice is valid only if it exactly matches a permitted uppercase letter. The letter and its meaning are recorded separately.

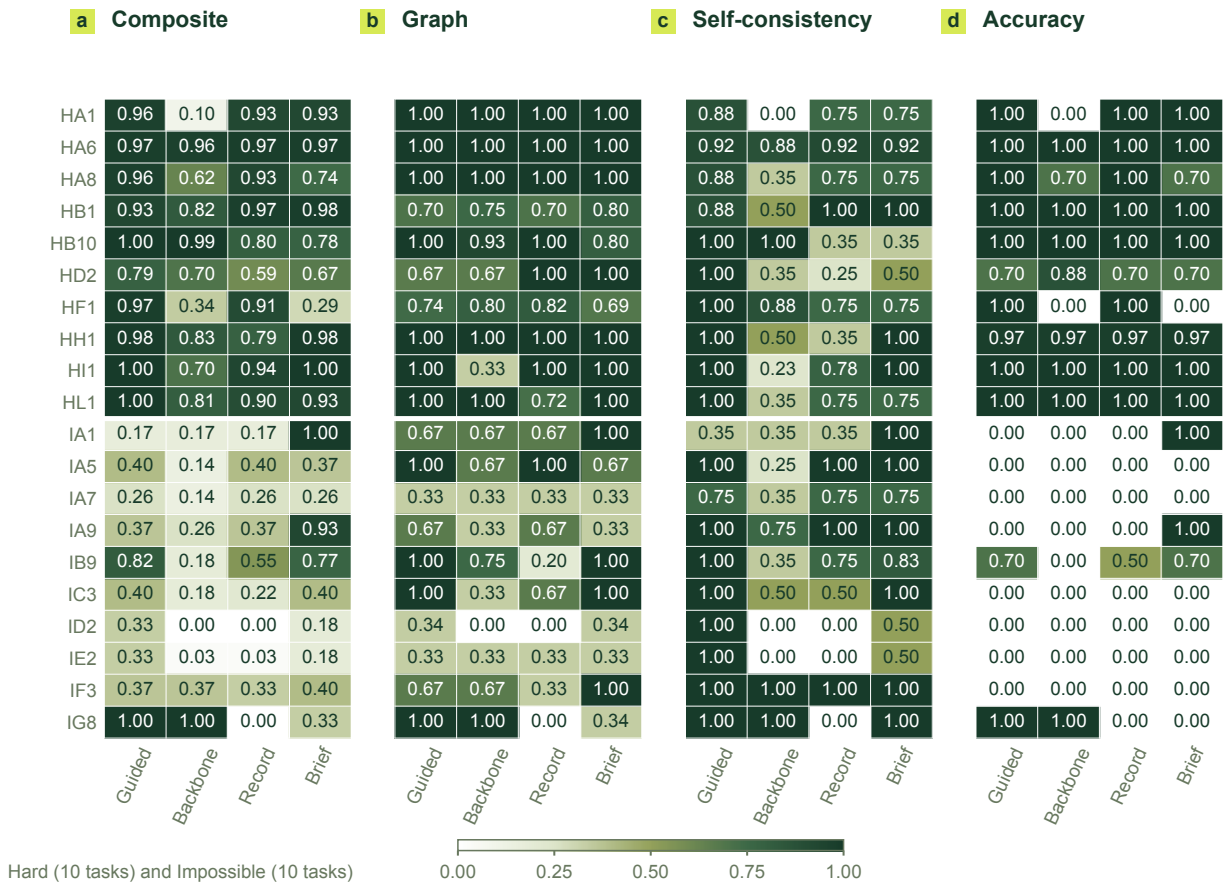


Figure S2. All Hard and Impossible task scores, with the same layer and configuration ordering as Figure S1. All 80 runs have complete composite and component values.

Table S23. Experimental units and crossed conditions of the local diagnostic studies.

Study	Frozen inputs and experimental factors	Calls
Chemical identity	16 pairs × 2 representations × 2 answer orders	64
Distance judgment	4 geometries × 2 information conditions × 2 answer orders × 2 thinking settings	32
Target-angle feedback	2 information conditions; 3 cyclic next-action permutations and 2 sufficiency permutations per condition	10
Evidence associations	4 chains × 2 association conditions × 2 presentations × 2 answer orders	32
Native diagnostic follow-up	20 identity inputs and 16 association inputs, each under 2 thinking settings	72
Outstanding requirements	3 state questions × 2 context conditions × 2 answer orders	12

Each call is counted once. Representation, answer-order, and information variants use the same source molecule, geometry, or calculation chain. The single expanded-budget distance follow-up is additional to the 32-call study. The activation replacement experiment is described separately below.

S5.2 Chemical identity under equivalent representations and answer reversal

Sixteen molecular pairs were derived from four task systems. They include pairs representing the same molecule, different connectivities with the same formula, changes in connectivity and formal-charge location, different double-bond stereochemistry, and protonation changes. Each pair was presented in its original notation and an equivalent rewriting, with both answer orders. In the forward order, A means the same chemical identity and B means different identities; in the swapped order the meanings exchange. The questions instruct the model to compare connectivity, bond orders, formal charges, and specified stereochemistry, allowing differences in traversal order, ring digits, and disconnected-component order.

Across the resulting 64 judgments, 58 answers were correct. For the same pair and answer order, equivalent rewriting changed the chemical judgment in four of 32 comparisons. For the same pair and representation, reversing the options changed the judgment in six of 32 comparisons. All six selected A in both option orders. In the same-formula pair `CC1CC=C1` and `C=C1CCC1`, the double bond lies within and outside the ring, respectively. The model answered A under all four representation/order conditions, even though A changed from "same" to "different" when the options were reversed.

Identical strings test whether the model recognizes a representation as matching itself. Equivalent rewritings test recognition of the same molecule in another notation. Different-identity controls test whether it detects changed connectivity or stereochemistry despite a shared molecular formula. All strings and expected judgments are saved with the diagnostic data.

S5.3 XYZ coordinates and explicitly measured distances

Four NB1 geometries were selected from the archived research trajectories. The local question asks which of two specified atom pairs has the shorter Euclidean distance. The original-XYZ condition supplies the complete geometry in its saved atom order. The measured-distance condition supplies program-calculated values for the same atom pairs. Each condition appears in both answer orders and in direct-answer and thinking modes, yielding 32 native chat calls. Table S24 gives the measured values used to construct the paired conditions; all atom indices are one-based.

Table S24. Distance comparisons derived from the four archived NB1 geometries.

Source workflow	Pair 1	d_1 (Å)	Pair 2	d_2 (Å)
Guided	C2–C4	2.029	O3–H8	1.248
Brief	C4–H11	2.197	O7–H11	0.981
Brief	C4–H11	1.388	O7–H11	1.362
Brief	C4–H11	2.386	O7–H11	0.968

Table S25. Complete outcomes of the native distance-judgment controls.

Thinking	Information	Calls	Correct	Valid wrong	Budget-truncated
Off	XYZ coordinates	8	4	4	0
Off	Measured distances	8	8	0	0
On	XYZ coordinates	8	7	0	1
On	Measured distances	8	8	0	0

A budget-truncated generation reached the 1,024-token ceiling while still awaiting a final choice. It remains in the eight-input denominator. A separate 2,048-token follow-up of that one input produced the correct choice after 1,353 generated tokens.

All eight direct-answer XYZ responses selected A, giving four correct answers; reversing the options changed the judgment for every source geometry. Measured distances gave eight correct answers in each thinking setting, with the same judgment under reversal. With thinking enabled, median generated-token counts over the eight paired inputs were 807.5 for XYZ and 86 for measured distances, including thinking tokens. Program-calculated distances let the model compare the requested quantities directly, as in program-aided language models.[23]

S5.4 Target-specific geometric feedback in an E1 operation chain

In the E1 trajectory, the agent seeks an anti-periplanar H7–C2–C3–Cl4 dihedral near 180° for the transferring hydrogen H7. It rotates the C3-side fragment about C2–C3 by $+120^\circ$ and -120° to produce candidates A and B, and sets the C3–Cl4 distance to 2.35 Å. The default report gives a dihedral involving H5. The agent requests the H7 dihedral needed to choose between the candidates.

Table S26. Dihedral measurements and circular residuals for the saved E1 candidates.

Candidate	Atom quadruplet	Signed angle ($^\circ$)	Distance to 180°
A	H5–C2–C3–Cl4	-55.7831	124.2169
A	H7–C2–C3–Cl4	59.3752	120.6248
B	H5–C2–C3–Cl4	64.2169	115.7831
B	H7–C2–C3–Cl4	179.3752	0.6248

The manuscript's Newman projections use the saved coordinates viewed along C2→C3, with projected bond directions normalized for display. Table S26 gives the signed angles and circular distances from the target. The agent subsequently submits candidate B as the transition-state guess, citing the H7 anti-periplanar arrangement and stretched C3–Cl4 bond.

Ten local tests ask what to do next and whether the available measurements suffice. The H5-only inputs withhold H7 values and XYZ coordinates; the H5-plus-H7 inputs add the measured H7 values. In all three cyclic option permutations, adding H7 changes the next-action answer from requesting that measurement to selecting candidate B. In two paired sufficiency tests, it changes the answer from requesting more measurements to judging the information sufficient. All values come from the saved geometries; only the measurements supplied to the model change.

S5.5 Single-token transfer of a reported numerical fact

The activation experiment uses the archived local quantized model for a reported-distance comparison.[24] We changed the first reported distance from 2.029 to 1.029 Å. The second distance remains 1.248 Å. This reverses the correct comparison. The clean and edited prompts each contain 124 tokens; their token IDs differ only at global position 53, corresponding to the initial digit of the changed measurement. The original-fact answer is B in the forward option order and A in the reversed order.

For each option order, the residual-stream state at position 53 is captured from the original prompt and transferred into the edited prompt at zero-based layers 7, 15, 31, and 47. The four layers are fixed in the experiment manifest. The readout is the full-vocabulary softmax probability mass assigned to the original-fact answer, summing its bare-letter and leading-space spellings. Table S27 preserves the clean, edited, and transferred-state values.

Table S27. Probability of the original-fact answer under single-position activation replacement.

Input / intervention	Forward: original answer B	Reversed: original answer A
Original input	0.954032	0.996932
Edited input	0.008694	0.073626
Transfer at layer 7	0.029099	0.955908
Transfer at layer 15	0.015033	0.717660
Transfer at layer 31	0.007961	0.072117
Transfer at layer 47	0.008763	0.069810

The readout uses the full vocabulary, with bare and leading-space answer tokens combined. It is distinct from an A/B-renormalized probability or a proportion of correct task runs.

Two controls are executed in both option orders. Self-replacement transfers the edited prompt's own state at the changed token; the prefix control transfers at unchanged token position 0. Both preserve every vocabulary logit, with a maximum absolute difference of 0 from the edited baseline. With reversed options, transfers at layers 7 and 15 substantially increase the probability of the original-fact answer. With forward options, the changes are smaller and the edited answer remains preferred. Changing the state at the distance token therefore affects the answer in this test, with an effect that depends on option order.

S5.6 Evidence associations under fixed local calculation facts

We used four calculation chains from three tasks to construct records with correct links and records with one changed link. The two NB1 chains come from the same run. Each record is presented as a flat list or with explicit links between calculations, in both answer orders, yielding $4 \times 2 \times 2 \times 2 = 32$ inputs. The changed link concerns the saddle-frequency geometry, IRC starting geometry, terminal-frame optimization input, or target species. Termination flags, convergence flags, energies, and imaginary-frequency values remain fixed.

The model is asked whether the calculations support the indicated reaction step. Linked inputs specify which geometry each frequency or IRC calculation uses, which terminal frame each endpoint optimization starts from, and which species the final minimum represents. The model answers all 16 linked inputs and 14 of 16 flat inputs correctly. Both flat-input errors occur with changed links and reversed options, in E1 and the second NB1 step. Explicit links state the calculation dependencies that the model must otherwise reconstruct from the list.[25]

The native-chat follow-up uses the two chains on which these errors occurred, retaining every correct/changed-link, flat/linked, and option-order variant: 16 association questions per thinking mode. It also retains all four variants of five identity pairs with first-stage errors: 20 identity questions per mode. Table S28 reports all outcomes of these 72 calls. With thinking disabled, native chat gives 14/20 correct identity answers and 14/16 correct association answers, as in the initial tests. With thinking enabled, association answers reach 16/16; identity questions produce eight correct final choices and 12 generations truncated at the common 1,024-token limit.

Table S28. Complete outcomes for the selected native diagnostic follow-up.

Rendering / mode	Family	Calls	Correct	Valid wrong	Budget-truncated
First-stage raw	Identity	20	14	6	0
First-stage raw	Association	16	14	2	0
Native, thinking off	Identity	20	14	6	0
Native, thinking off	Association	16	14	2	0
Native, thinking on	Identity	20	8	0	12
Native, thinking on	Association	16	16	0	0

The first-stage rows are the selected records from the existing 96-input identity/association study. The four native rows contain 72 additional calls. All selected base cases retain their complete frozen variants; budget-truncated inputs remain in the denominators.

S5.7 From a detected gap to the next research action

The HA1 and NB1 trajectories show what the agents did after receiving diagnostics. In a Brief HA1 run, the agent repeatedly changed the source-minimum reference after compact feedback, while the IRC endpoint link remained unresolved. In a Guided NB1 run, the frequency calculation found zero imaginary modes and returned a normal-mode diagnostic. The Coordinator requested changes to the transition-state guess and optimization constraints; the next calculation used those changes. The saved sequences connect each diagnostic to the next instruction and calculation request.[21]

In IA1, the delivery report has `complete=false`, a pending bidirectional short-IRC verification, and an empty formal-waiver list. After earlier positive comments about intermediate optimization, the Coordinator requests to stop with the study marked complete. The completion check returns the pending IRC requirement to the model. The next stop request marks the study partial.

The local IA1 test asks three questions: whether the latest report declares completion, whether a formal short-IRC waiver exists, and whether the missing calculation remains required. Each question is presented with the report alone or a quoted 12-message history, in both answer orders. All 12 answers match the recorded report fields and waiver list; all six option-reversed pairs preserve the same judgment.

S5.8 Discussion of the diagnostic scope

The tests examine whether a model recognizes a molecule in different notations, compares distances, requests measurements for the specified atoms, uses a supplied numerical fact, detects changed calculation links, and identifies pending IRC verification. They describe the recorded local model and the tested inputs. The native follow-up uses cases selected after first-stage errors and retains all their variants; its counts apply to that selected set. The common output limit bounds response length; actual computation depends on prompt conditioning and the tokens generated in each thinking mode.

Activation replacement measures the effect of a changed state on the quantized Qwen model's distance-comparison answer. Establishing the original DeepSeek runs' internal mechanism or the chemical validity of their results requires separate evidence. In the E1 trajectory, Supervisor/workspace input intervenes between the measurements and the agent's use of candidate B. The separate local tests vary the supplied target measurements to examine their effect on the choice.

The completed IA1 tests use the report-only and 12-message inputs. A separate request with the full 306-message history contained 242,803 counted input tokens in a 262,144-token context. It reached the 3,600-s HTTP waiting limit while awaiting an answer, leaving the saved response empty. Of six planned full-history inputs, the first was attempted and the other five remain unattempted. This incomplete request is recorded separately from the 12 completed short-context judgments.

S6 Literature sample and source-linked capability register

S6.1 Selection and coding procedure

The literature sample contains 85 chemical AI agent systems, architectures, or workflows in the sources collected by 27 October 2026. Each included an LLM that planned calculations, used tools, modified inputs or code, or acted on feedback during an executed molecular, atomistic, or molecular coarse-grained calculation. Each separately described system or workflow counts once; journal and preprint versions and aliases are merged. The register lists the original sources, supporting passages, and coding decisions.

Systems were classified by what their examples studied: materials, crystals, and surfaces (39); finite molecules and complexes (23); liquids, soft matter, and biomolecules (12); or multiple classes (11). A periodic box containing a protein, liquid, or polymer was classified by its contents. The 85 records cover the sampled literature; Cloudra is shown separately in the manuscript figures.

Task codes mark activities demonstrated in the sources: T, structure construction/editing; E, separately demonstrated static energy, electronic structure, or material-property calculations; O, geometry optimization/relaxation; F, vibrations/frequencies and associated thermochemistry; R, explicit reaction paths or transition-state searches, including solid-state NEB; D, molecular or quantum dynamics. A record can have multiple codes. Their counts are 61, 61, 53, 22, 11, and 37, respectively. A blank leaves the activity unencoded and the system's capability in that category open. The register identifies coarse-grained normal modes and MD-derived free-energy profiles as such.

S6.2 Source register and counting variants

Table S29 links each system to its primary article or official project record and any additional sources. The files `companion_data/literature/systems.json` and `companion_data/literature/source_index.csv` give the source location and supporting description for each code. They also list the demonstrated targets, boundary conditions, aliases, system families, and access limitations. Screening and search records include a crosswalk to the 49-system review used to find sources.

The main manuscript uses separately described systems/workflows. Grouping the specified El Agente, MDAgent, MatAgent/ChatMat, and DynaMate/DynaMate2 families gives 75 records (37 materials/surfaces, 17 molecules/complexes, 11 soft/biomolecular, and 10 multiple-class records). Excluding the three official-demonstration-only systems gives 82 records (38, 21, 12, 11); additionally excluding MLP Copilot gives 81 (37, 21, 12, 11). These counting variants are retained with their definitions in the source data.

Table S29. Complete source-linked register of the 85 chemical AI agent systems/workflows used in the literature sample. Task codes are defined in the text. L01–L85 link to the primary records; lettered links give additional sources.

No.	System/workflow	Demonstrated object class	Task codes	Original sources
1	Buehler molecular-DFT multi-agent demonstration	Molecules/complexes	T E	L01, a
2	ProtAgents	Soft/biomolecular	T F	L02, a
3	LLaMP	Materials/surfaces	T D	L03
4	ChemReasoner	Materials/surfaces	E O T	L04
5	AtomAgents	Materials/surfaces	T E O R	L05
6	Adsorb-Agent	Materials/surfaces	T E O	L06
7	LangSim	Materials/surfaces	T E O	L07, a
8	MDCrow	Soft/biomolecular	D	L08
9	MDAgent	Materials/surfaces	D	L09
10	El Agente Q	Molecules/complexes	T E O F	L10
11	Aitomia	Molecules/complexes	T E O F	L11
12	DynaMate (Mendible-Barreto et al.)	Multiple classes	T O D	L12, a, b
13	MatAgent (Lv et al.)	Molecules/complexes	T E	L13
14	ChemGraph	Molecules/complexes	T E O F	L14
15	TopoMAS	Materials/surfaces	T E	L15
16	NAMD-Agent	Soft/biomolecular	T D	L16, a
17	DREAMS	Materials/surfaces	T E O	L17
18	SparksMatter	Materials/surfaces	T E O	L18
19	AutoSolvate-Agent	Molecules/complexes	T E O F	L19, a, b
20	VASPilot	Materials/surfaces	E O	L20
21	ChemAgents molecular simulation workflow	Molecules/complexes	F D	L21, a
22	AMLP	Materials/surfaces	E O D	L22
23	ToPolyAgent	Soft/biomolecular	T D	L23, a
24	GENIUS	Materials/surfaces	E O	L24, a
25	LAMMPS-Agents	Materials/surfaces	T E O F D	L25, a, b
26	DynaMate (protein–ligand)	Soft/biomolecular	T O D	L26, a
27	AGAPI-Agents	Materials/surfaces	T E O	L27
28	MASTER	Materials/surfaces	T E O	L28
29	El Agente Cuántico	Molecules/complexes	E	L29, a
30	VASP Agent	Materials/surfaces	E O R	L30
31	Masgent	Materials/surfaces	T E O	L31
32	CASCADE	Materials/surfaces	E O	L32
33	MDAgent2-RUNTIME	Materials/surfaces	D	L33, a
34	CatMaster	Materials/surfaces	T E O F R	L34
35	QUASAR	Multiple classes	T E O D	L35
36	ChatMat	Molecules/complexes	T E	L36, a, b, c
37	El Agente Estructural	Molecules/complexes	T O	L37
38	El Agente Quntur	Molecules/complexes	T E O F R	L38
39	El Agente Gráfico	Multiple classes	T E O F	L39, a
40	El Agente Sólido	Materials/surfaces	T E O F	L40
41	Catalyst-Agent	Materials/surfaces	T E O	L41
42	TritonDFT	Materials/surfaces	E O F	L42
43	Chelatron	Molecules/complexes	T E	L43
44	Electrolyte Agent / Reasoning-to-Simulation	Soft/biomolecular	T D	L44, a
45	MatSciAgent	Materials/surfaces	T D	L45

Continued on the next page

Table S29 (continued)

No.	System/workflow	Demonstrated object class	Task codes	Original sources
46	OpenClaw computational-chemistry skills workflow	Molecules/complexes	T O D	L46
47	Protomia	Molecules/complexes	T E F	L47, a
48	SimMOF	Materials/surfaces	T E O D	L48
49	PolyJarvis	Soft/biomolecular	T D	L49
50	FermiLink	Multiple classes	E D	L50
51	MatClaw	Materials/surfaces	E D	L51
52	El Agente Forjador	Molecules/complexes	T E O F D	L52
53	MDAgent (biomolecular, 2026)	Soft/biomolecular	T O D	L53, a
54	VirtualLab_CC	Molecules/complexes	T E O F	L54, a, b
55	XDFT	Materials/surfaces	T E	L55
56	CatGo	Multiple classes	T E O F R	L56, a, b, c
57	TSAgent	Materials/surfaces	E O F R	L57
58	Lang2MLIP	Materials/surfaces	T E D	L58
59	AtomisticSkills	Multiple classes	T E O D	L59
60	DynaMate2	Soft/biomolecular	T D	L60, a
61	ChatMOSP	Materials/surfaces	T	L61
62	AutoDFT	Multiple classes	E O F D	L62
63	MLIPilot	Multiple classes	E O D	L63
64	CatDT	Materials/surfaces	T E O F R	L64
65	Paimon	Multiple classes	T O D	L65
66	MDForge	Soft/biomolecular	D	L66
67	URSA LAMMPS agent	Materials/surfaces	T E D	L67, a
68	AdsMind	Materials/surfaces	T E O	L68
69	LADeQ	Molecules/complexes	E	L69
70	MutexaGPT	Soft/biomolecular	T D	L70, a
71	Agent-MD	Materials/surfaces	D	L71
72	CGMas	Soft/biomolecular	T O D	L72
73	matmcp	Materials/surfaces	T E O	L73, a, b
74	Evolving TS workflows	Molecules/complexes	O F R	L74
75	ARCHE	Molecules/complexes	T E O F R	L75
76	Multireference QC agent	Molecules/complexes	E	L76
77	El Agente Potente	Multiple classes	T E O F R D	L77
78	PVmatAgent	Materials/surfaces	T E O	L78, a, b
79	Agent-E2MD	Materials/surfaces	E O D	L79
80	SQD-Agent	Molecules/complexes	E	L80
81	QAOS / Quantum Agentic Operating System	Molecules/complexes	T E O	L81, a
82	MLP Copilot	Materials/surfaces	E D	L82, a
83	Magnolia	Multiple classes	T E O D	L83
84	GBClaw	Materials/surfaces	T E O R	L84, a
85	PULSES	Molecules/complexes	T E O D	L85, a

S7 Data, software, and reproduction materials

S7.1 Public data availability

The study data are publicly available with read-only access at `https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1yZo3eJuCUuAgedQztgCtLyJcc8MZipf7`. This directory provides the full P2 campaign archive `Cloudra-P2-final-20261031-FULL.tar.gz`, the 48-run P1b repeated-task archive and its offline-organization supplements, the Gold reference-calculation evidence snapshot, and the compact SI companion-data archive `Cloudra_SI_Data.zip`. The

package versions, inventories, and checksums are provided with the downloads.

The P2 archive contains the 200 full-benchmark runs; the P1b archive contains the separate 48 repeated-task runs. The Gold archive contains reference calculation inputs, native outputs, geometries, Hessians, and curation records. The SI companion archive contains task definitions, full-precision scores, behavioral records, and the materials used to reproduce the publication tables and figures.

The separate complete behavioral-source archive (20261030) contains frozen inputs and responses, activation states and logits, readable event traces, source databases and calculation records, analysis scripts, and vector figures. Its topic index and manuscript-context files identify the section and figure numbers used in that manuscript version.

S7.2 Machine-readable task and score records

The supplementary source package contains `companion_data/cloudrabench_50_task_catalogue.csv`, the 50 task JSON files in `companion_data/task_definitions/`, and `companion_data/cloudrabench_200_run_scores.csv`. The task files contain molecular inputs, task text, permitted methods, Gold graphs, and scoring settings. The score table stores all 200 composites and 600 components at their original precision. A manifest records file hashes and the precision displayed in the printed tables.

The P2 publication-source package contains the final evaluations, paired summaries, Brief/Impossible analyses, extracted timing data, and field sources used in the figures. The manifest `companion_data/evaluation_manifest.json` records reference task-file hashes, evaluator revision `0961d9ab`, and the source of each run's score. The reproduction script reads these records to assemble the 200-run table; the plotting scripts use the resulting tables. All reproduced results derive from the retained run records.

S7.3 Software responsibilities and calculation records

Cloudra revision 70daa5a identifies the implementation described in the main-text methods.[2] RDKit and ETKDG supply molecular representations and coordinate embedding; MMFF94 supplies force-field relaxation.[18, 26–28] NumPy supplies numerical array/linear-algebra operations, NetworkX supplies graph representation and matching, and cclib works with engine-specific readers to extract quantum-chemical quantities.[19, 29, 30] ASE supplies the NEB/MDMin implementation used in standard IDPP, and Adam is used in the lightweight interpolation path.[31–34] Task-name semantic projections use BGE-M3 embeddings and scikit-learn PCA.[35, 36] Publication tables are assembled with pandas, and the quantitative figures are drawn with Matplotlib.[37, 38]

Each run records the program, model/API name, charge, spin, method, basis, and keywords used for its calculations and model requests. These records identify the experimental versions; dependency lower bounds specify installation requirements. Native outputs contain stationary-point energies, frequencies, normal modes, IRC geometries, and the links to endpoint optimization and frequency calculations. Numerical barriers use the electronic-energy difference in Equation S1.

S7.4 Reproduction entry points

Within the accompanying Cloudra repository, the following commands reconstruct the retained P2 publication tables and figures:

```
python scripts/benchmark_p2/prepare_publication_data.py
python scripts/benchmark_p2/plot_benchmark_results.py
python scripts/benchmark_p2/plot_speed_delivery.py
python scripts/benchmark_p2/plot_imp.py
```

The companion-data archive contains the same directory layout under `companion_data/publication_reproduction/`; run the four commands from that directory. It also includes the timing extractions and frozen behavioral requests and responses. The activation archive contains the original prompts, intervention commands, captured states, and full-vocabulary logits, which directly reproduce the reported probabilities and equal-logit controls. Replay and analysis scripts are in `companion_data/behavioral_scripts/`; model weights remain outside the archive. The literature directory contains the complete register, screening records, and search history. Editable TeX files, vector figures, and the bibliography accompany this SI for subsequent revision.

S7.5 Data-package inventory

The SI companion-data archive is distributed separately from the compact Overleaf typesetting project. Unpack `Cloudra_SI_Data.zip` beside the SI source to obtain the referenced `companion_data/` directory. Its subdirectories contain the following materials:

- `task_definitions/`: all 50 final reference task definitions, including molecular inputs and rubrics.
- `publication_reproduction/`: publication input records, field provenance, bootstrap summaries, timing records, and table/figure scripts.
- `behavioral/`: frozen input sets, actual request/response records, deployment snapshots, geometric/evidence source cases, and activation readouts.
- `behavioral_scripts/`: the corresponding intervention and diagnostic code.

- `revision_20261031/`: deployment/version metadata, archive-relative configuration and request summaries, inspected Easy-task trajectories, and the conditional Impossible target-assignment scenarios.
- `literature/`: all 85 source-linked systems and the coding/search records.

A file-level SHA-256 inventory accompanies the archive. Source data retain their recorded precision; the SI analyzes the retained agent runs and quantum-chemical calculations.

References

[1] DeepSeek-AI. DeepSeek V4 Model Card, 2026. URL `https://fe-static.deepseek.com/chat/transparency/deepseek-V4-model-card-EN.pdf`.

[2] Cloudra. Cloudra source code, 2026. URL `https://github.com/yyywaa/Cloudra-mechanism-agent/tree/70daa5a`. Revision 70daa5a, 26 October 2026.

[3] Philipp Pracht, Fabian Bohle, and Stefan Grimme. Automated exploration of the low-energy chemical space with fast quantum chemical methods. *Physical Chemistry Chemical Physics*, 22(14):7169–7192, 2020. doi: 10.1039/C9CP06869D.

[4] Christoph Bannwarth, Sebastian Ehlert, and Stefan Grimme. GFN2-xTB—an accurate and broadly parametrized self-consistent tight-binding quantum chemical method with multipole electrostatics and density-dependent dispersion contributions. *Journal of Chemical Theory and Computation*, 15(3):1652–1671, 2019. doi: 10.1021/acs.jctc.8b01176.

[5] James J. P. Stewart. Optimization of parameters for semiempirical methods VI: more modifications to the NDDO approximations and re-optimization of parameters. *Journal of Molecular Modeling*, 19(1):1–32, 2013. doi: 10.1007/s00894-012-1667-x.

[6] Axel D. Becke. Density-functional thermochemistry. III. the role of exact exchange. *The Journal of Chemical Physics*, 98(7): 5648–5652, 1993. doi: 10.1063/1.464913.

[7] Chengteh Lee, Weitao Yang, and Robert G. Parr. Development of the Colle–Salvetti correlation-energy formula into a functional of the electron density. *Physical Review B*, 37(2):785–789, 1988. doi: 10.1103/PhysRevB.37.785.

[8] P. J. Stephens, F. J. Devlin, C. F. Chabalowski, and M. J. Frisch. Ab initio calculation of vibrational absorption and circular dichroism spectra using density functional force fields. *The Journal of Physical Chemistry*, 98(45):11623–11627, 1994. doi: 10.1021/j100096a001.

[9] Stefan Grimme, Jens Antony, Stephan Ehrlich, and Helge Krieg. A consistent and accurate ab initio parametrization of density functional dispersion correction (DFT-D) for the 94 elements H–Pu. *The Journal of Chemical Physics*, 132(15):154104, 2010. doi: 10.1063/1.3382344.

[10] Stefan Grimme, Stephan Ehrlich, and Lars Goerigk. Effect of the damping function in dispersion corrected density functional theory. *Journal of Computational Chemistry*, 32(7):1456–1465, 2011. doi: 10.1002/jcc.21759.

[11] Florian Weigend and Reinhart Ahlrichs. Balanced basis sets of split valence, triple zeta valence and quadruple zeta valence quality for H to Rn: Design and assessment of accuracy. *Physical Chemistry Chemical Physics*, 7:3297–3305, 2005. doi: 10.1039/B508541A.

[12] Frank Neese. Software update: The ORCA program system—version 6.0. *WIREs Computational Molecular Science*, 15(2): e70019, 2025. doi: 10.1002/wcms.70019.

[13] M. J. Frisch, G. W. Trucks, H. B. Schlegel, G. E. Scuseria, M. A. Robb, J. R. Cheeseman, G. Scalmani, V. Barone, G. A. Petersson, H. Nakatsuji, et al. Gaussian 16. Gaussian, Inc., Wallingford, CT, 2016. URL `https://gaussian.com/citation/`.

[14] Jonathan E. Moussa and James J. P. Stewart. MOPAC: An open-source semiempirical molecular orbital program. *Journal of Open Source Software*, 11(119):8025, 2026. doi: 10.21105/joss.08025.

[15] FACCTs. ORCA 6.1 Manual, 2025. URL `https://www.faccts.de/docs/orca/6.1/manual/`. Online documentation; accessed 31 October 2026.

[16] K. Fukui. Formulation of the reaction coordinate. *The Journal of Physical Chemistry*, 74:4161–4163, 1970. doi: 10.1021/j100717a029.

[17] S. Maeda, Y. Harabuchi, Y. Ono, T. Taketsugu, and K. Morokuma. Intrinsic reaction coordinate: Calculation, bifurcation, and automated search. *International Journal of Quantum Chemistry*, 115:258–269, 2015. doi: 10.1002/qua.24757.

[18] RDKit. Getting Started in Python: Conformer Generation and Maximum Common Substructure, 2026. URL `https://www.rdkit.org/docs/GettingStartedInPython.html`. Online documentation; accessed 31 October 2026.

[19] Aric A. Hagberg, Daniel A. Schult, and Pieter J. Swart. Exploring network structure, dynamics, and function using NetworkX. In Gaël Varoquaux, Travis Vaught, and Jarrod Millman, editors, *Proceedings of the 7th Python in Science Conference*, pages 11–15, Pasadena, CA, 2008. URL `https://aric.hagberg.org/papers/hagberg-2008-exploring.pdf`.

[20] Karthik Valmeekam, Matthew Marquez, Sarath Sreedharan, and Subbarao Kambhampati. On the planning abilities of large language models: A critical investigation. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems*, 2023. URL `https://arxiv.org/abs/2305.15771`.

[21] Zhibin Gou, Zhihong Shao, Yeyun Gong, Yelong Shen, Yujiu Yang, Nan Duan, and Weizhu Chen. CRITIC: Large language models can self-correct with tool-interactive critiquing. In *International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2024. URL `https://arxiv.org/abs/2305.11738`.

[22] Jie Huang, Xinyun Chen, Swaroop Mishra, Huaixiu Steven Zheng, Adams Wei Yu, Xinying Song, and Denny Zhou. Large language models cannot self-correct reasoning yet. In *International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2024. URL `https://arxiv.org/abs/2310.01798`.

[23] Luyu Gao, Aman Madaan, Shuyan Zhou, Uri Alon, Pengfei Liu, Yiming Yang, Jamie Callan, and Graham Neubig. PAL: Program-aided language models. In *Proceedings of the 40th International Conference on Machine Learning*, volume 202, pages 10764–10799, 2023. URL https://proceedings.mlr.press/v202/gao23f.html.

[24] Fred Zhang and Neel Nanda. Towards Best Practices of Activation Patching in Language Models: Metrics and Methods. In *International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2024. URL https://proceedings.iclr.cc/paper_files/paper/2024/hash/06a52a54c8ee03cd86771136bc91eb1f-Abstract-Conference.html.

[25] Bahar Fatemi, Bryan Perozzi, and Jonathan Halcrow. Talk like a Graph: Encoding Graphs for Large Language Models. In *International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2024. URL https://research.google/pubs/talk-like-a-graph-encoding-graphs-for-large-language-models/.

[26] S. Riniker and G. A. Landrum. Better Informed Distance Geometry: Using What We Know To Improve Conformation Generation. *Journal of Chemical Information and Modeling*, 55:2562–2574, 2015. doi: 10.1021/acs.jcim.5b00654.

[27] Shuzhe Wang, Jagna Witek, Gregory A. Landrum, and Sereina Riniker. Improving conformer generation for small rings and macrocycles based on distance geometry and experimental torsional-angle preferences. *Journal of Chemical Information and Modeling*, 60(4):2044–2058, 2020. doi: 10.1021/acs.jcim.0c00025.

[28] Thomas A. Halgren. Merck molecular force field. I. basis, form, scope, parameterization, and performance of MMFF94. *Journal of Computational Chemistry*, 17(5–6):490–519, 1996. doi: 10.1002/(SICI)1096-987X(199604)17:5/6<490::AID-JCC1>3.0.CO;2-P.

[29] Charles R. Harris, K. Jarrod Millman, Stéfan J. van der Walt, Ralf Gommers, Pauli Virtanen, David Cournapeau, Eric Wieser, Julian Taylor, Sebastian Berg, Nathaniel J. Smith, Robert Kern, Matti Picus, Stephan Hoyer, Marten H. van Kerkwijk, Matthew Brett, Allan Haldane, Jaime Fernández del Río, Mark Wiebe, Pearu Peterson, Pierre Gérard-Marchant, Kevin Sheppard, Tyler Reddy, Warren Weckesser, Hameer Abbasi, Christoph Gohlke, and Travis E. Oliphant. Array programming with NumPy. *Nature*, 585(7825):357–362, 2020. doi: 10.1038/s41586-020-2649-2.

[30] Noel M. O'Boyle, Adam L. Tenderholt, and Karol M. Langner. cclib: A library for package-independent computational chemistry algorithms. *Journal of Computational Chemistry*, 29(5):839–845, 2008. doi: 10.1002/jcc.20823.

[31] Søren Smidstrup, Andreas Pedersen, Kurt Stokbro, and Hannes Jónsson. Improved initial guess for minimum energy path calculations. *The Journal of Chemical Physics*, 140(21):214106, 2014. doi: 10.1063/1.4878664.

[32] Graeme Henkelman and Hannes Jónsson. Improved tangent estimate in the nudged elastic band method for finding minimum energy paths and saddle points. *The Journal of Chemical Physics*, 113(22):9978–9985, 2000. doi: 10.1063/1.1323224.

[33] Ask Hjorth Larsen, Jens Jørgen Mortensen, Jakob Blomqvist, Ivano E. Castelli, Rune Christensen, Marcin Dułak, Jesper Friis, Michael N. Groves, Bjørk Hammer, Cory Hargus, et al. The atomic simulation environment—a Python library for working with atoms. *Journal of Physics: Condensed Matter*, 29(27):273002, 2017. doi: 10.1088/1361-648X/aa680e.

[34] Diederik P. Kingma and Jimmy Ba. Adam: A method for stochastic optimization. In *International Conference on Learning Representations*, 2015. URL https://arxiv.org/abs/1412.6980.

[35] Jianlyu Chen, Shitao Xiao, Peitian Zhang, Kun Luo, Defu Lian, and Zheng Liu. M3-Embedding: Multi-linguality, multi-functionality, multi-granularity text embeddings through self-knowledge distillation. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2024*, pages 2318–2335, 2024. doi: 10.18653/v1/2024.findings-acl.137. URL https://aclanthology.org/2024.findings-acl.137/.

[36] F. Pedregosa, G. Varoquaux, A. Gramfort, V. Michel, B. Thirion, O. Grisel, M. Blondel, P. Prettenhofer, R. Weiss, V. Dubourg, J. Vanderplas, A. Passos, D. Cournapeau, M. Brucher, M. Perrot, and E. Duchesnay. Scikit-learn: Machine learning in Python. *Journal of Machine Learning Research*, 12:2825–2830, 2011. URL https://jmlr.org/papers/v12/pedregosa11a.html.

[37] Wes McKinney. Data structures for statistical computing in Python. In *Proceedings of the 9th Python in Science Conference*, 2010. doi: 10.25080/Majora-92bf1922-00a.

[38] John D. Hunter. Matplotlib: A 2d graphics environment. *Computing in Science & Engineering*, 9(3):90–95, 2007. doi: 10.1109/MCSE.2007.55.